

# Iran War Risk

## Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22\_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22\_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28\_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29\_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22\_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31\_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran's Larak Island — the first US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a

resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01\_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02\_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026,** retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05\_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05\_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06\_draft):** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08\_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09\_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the

closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped\_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10\_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped\_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-11\_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 10-11: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES on a third consecutive session — Brent closed Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, its highest since May 19, with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent) — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar on every scored fact, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped\_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-12\_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 11-12: Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 — capturing the final government-held coastal towns (Dhubab, Murad) and Houthi naval forces seizing Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a materially more severe status (actual control of a second global chokepoint's own islands) than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels near Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating); an IRGC claim of a Sairdron strike is single-source and not used to move P. Yemen is an existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire; no US casualty, so that clause doesn't either — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a fresh clause firing. **P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped\_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **LATER THE SAME DAY (Sept 12): a separate FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12\_draft2), the first full-weekly-depth research dive since the Sept 5 full weekly refresh, ran four parallel adversarial research passes across all four qualitative pillars against the 2026-09-12\_draft committed baseline (1/2/18/38/70).** One new dated fact clears the sufficiency bar: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, a NEW target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation issued Sept 11). PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com) with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. No group has claimed responsibility; President Trump, in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a single, hedged, unconfirmed remark, logged as such, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). Neither flip-line clause fires: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — escalation within an existing theater, not a new one), and the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty found); the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged, not scored: Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept

12, all members plus Saudi Arabia/Iran/UAE) urging "maximum restraint" over the escalation — a mild long-horizon diplomatic data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) was independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). Sized small given a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty: **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **WEEKLY REFRESH — left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size.** Committed by Alex; Sept 13-14 light daily catch-ups held flat with nothing new clearing the sufficiency bar, AUTO-STAMPED. **Sept 16 (score set 2026-09-16\_draft):** RE-RATED DOWN on the 6/12/36mo windows to 1/1/14/33/66 (from 1/1/18/38/70) — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council, and 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a Sept 12-13 statement calling for NPT withdrawal, with a hardline MP describing an emergency bill being drafted (RFE/RL, Tehran Times, Mehr News); Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons stance and the Foreign Ministry's "still being prepared" framing kept the move modest. AUTO-STAMPED, the last TRUE committed baseline. **THIS VERSION (Sept 17, score set 2026-09-17\_draft) HOLDS FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66** — re-checked, no new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced; Pezeshkian's and the Foreign Ministry's positions are unchanged. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. **Sept 18 (score set 2026-09-18\_draft, this version) HOLDS FLAT again at 1/1/14/33/66.** Two dated items were found and weighed. Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a Tuesday UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders — dated and multi-sourced (Axios original, corroborated by Times of Israel, Politico Wire, Breitbart, RedState, Western Journal, anews — 5+ independent), but it is rhetoric about an undated future decision, and the near-term windows (1mo/3mo P=1) already price maximal active-war uncertainty, so it does not clear the bar for a further move. Separately, an initial general search surfaced a claim that the IRGC struck a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 18; a follow-up targeted search could not independently corroborate this from any named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC) source — **treated as NOT FIRED / NOT USED** per this report's house discipline for uncorroborated single claims. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (Sept 19, score set 2026-09-19\_draft) is a FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-09-18\_draft) — independent primary-source research across all five windows found nothing that clears the sufficiency bar for a move. Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal: 130 lawmakers signed a further Sept 7-13 statement urging the legal Article X process, Parliament Presidium spokesman Abbas Goudarzi said withdrawal "can easily" be done, and a bill was submitted for expedited consideration — but Iran's own Foreign Ministry still calls it "in preparation," so this remains a proposal, not a completed act (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarnyi, IFP News — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated, the same treatment this pillar has always given Iranian-sourced claims). Trump told Axios (Sept 17) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman) — very well corroborated (Axios, Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News, 5+ independent), but still rhetoric about an undated future decision; **the Sept 22 meeting itself is now flagged as this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.** The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel, Russia and China dissenting (Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) — a primary UN press release (press.un.org, sc16455 and related), corroborated by Euronews and Security Council Report — institutional gridlock over the 2025 snapback dispute, not a new sanction or act of war. The Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike (Sept 17-18) this pillar could not corroborate last cycle is now CONFIRMED via the IRGC's own statement (IRNA, primary, via GlobalSecurity.org) plus independent outlets including The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, and Rio Times — reversing last cycle's NOT FIRED call, but it is a continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign (the US struck three Iranian tankers Sept 1-5), not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P. Brent settled ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18 (CNBC, Al Jazeera), down 1.5% day-over-day but still near the multi-month highs reached in early September — a market price, not scored. Iran has now gone nine straight days without striking a "host state" (GlobalSecurity.org's OSINT day-by-day tracker) — a mild, fragile de-escalatory data point — while a Houthis-linked air-raid alert hit Riyadh Sept 19 for the first time since July (Times of Israel liveblog) — a mixed signal on the proxy front; neither clears the bar alone. FM Araghchi said Iran and Oman "agreed a plan" to reopen the Strait (TASS, Caspianpost) but separately clarified the Oman understanding will NOT by itself reopen Hormuz, conditioned on the US honoring the 60-day Islamabad MOU (Mehr News, corroborated by Samaa) — a net wash. **P HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66 — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.** See My Decision below. **Updated & Re-verified September 22, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-22\_draft: carried forward unchanged at 1/1/14/33/66 — not re-researched this cycle; Fed & Macro re-rated down instead. COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 22, 2026. Updated & Re-verified September 23, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-23\_draft: RE-RATED UP to 3/3/16/35/66,**

the first upward move since Sept 13. A senior Iranian official told Reuters (Sept 22, 8+ outlet corroboration) Iran can reopen Hormuz within 7 days if the US eases pressure and lifts its blockade; separately, US officials (Witkoff/Kushner) and Iran's FM Araghchi held a 3-hour "very productive" mediated meeting at the UN General Assembly sidelines Sept 22, the first direct US-Iran contact at this level since the war began, with another meeting scheduled soon. Sized modestly against Iran's still-steep unmet conditions (full blockade lift, all frozen assets released, end to war on every named front), Pezeshkian declining to meet Trump directly, and continued unattributed Sept 21 tanker incidents. **COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 23, 2026.**

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 19, 2026 · **Updated & Re-verified September 26, 2026** — FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-26\_draft3: RE-RATED as a WINDOW SPLIT, 3/3/16/35/66 → 1/2/15/34/66 (~1/+2, day Hormuz-reopening plan outside the UN Security Council on Sept 25 (AP, Reuters and Al Jazeera as independent originals), and Pezeshkian offered to readmit UN nuclear inspectors in a C ACTIONS run the other way: a cargo vessel struck in Hormuz Sept 23, two Houthis salvos at Saudi Arabia, the blockade intact, transits at ~9–18/day against ~125 pre-war, and Brent back above was written but never delivered, and its claim that no tanker incidents occurred Sept 23–24 was FALSIFIED on re-verification. · Prior: Updated & Re-verified September 18, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score already at this pillar's practical floor; a claim of an IRGC strike on a tanker named "Trend" could NOT be independently corroborated on a follow-up targeted search and was NOT FIRED / NOT USED. · CO HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66). Iran's parliament continues moving toward but has NOT enacted NPT withdrawal (still "in preparation" per its own Foreign Ministry) — a proposal, not a completed act. Trump trigger to watch next cycle. The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing, Somalia/Pakistan abstaining, Sept 17) to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel — institutional gridlock, not continuation of an already-active tanker campaign, not new escalation, so it updates the record without moving P. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-sta carried forward unchanged at 1/1/14/33/66 — not re-researched this cycle; Fed & Macro re-rated down instead (see that pillar's report). COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 22, 2026. · Updated & Hormuz within 7 days if the US eases pressure and lifts its blockade. Separately, US officials (Witkoff/Kushner) and Iran's FM Araghchi held a 3-hour "very productive" mediated meeting at the UN Genera unattributed Sept 21 tanker incidents. · COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED · Last TRUE committed: 3/3/16/35/66 (2026-09-23\_draft, auto-stamped Sept 23) · Not Financial Advice · **Updated & Re-verified S RE-RATED, window split, 3/3/16/35/66 → 2/4/17/35/66).** Trump's Sept 22 UNGA address — unpriced by yesterday's cycle and logged as such — put a deal "right after the election." The Nov 3 midterms point. The Sept 23 "road map" story is single-narrative-sourced and deliberately not used; the Pentagon's 19th US death is NON-HOSTILE and does not fire the combat-death flip line.

| WINDOW   | JUN | ... | 8/22<br>(COMMITTED) | 8/31<br>(COMMITTED) | 9/1<br>(COMMITTED) | 9/2<br>(COMMITTED) | 9/5 D2<br>(COMMITTED) | 9/6<br>(COMMITTED) | 9/8<br>(COMMITTED) | 9/9 | 9/10 | 9/11<br>(COMMITTED) | 9/12<br>(COMMITTED) |
|----------|-----|-----|---------------------|---------------------|--------------------|--------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|--------------------|-----|------|---------------------|---------------------|
| 1 month  | 50  | ... | 14                  | 9                   | 7                  | 1                  | 1                     | 1                  | 1                  | 1   | 1    | 1                   | 1                   |
| 3 months | 55  | ... | 22                  | 17                  | 15                 | 9                  | 9                     | 8                  | 7                  | 6   | 5    | 4                   | 2                   |
| 6 months | 62  | ... | 38                  | 34                  | 32                 | 27                 | 27                    | 25                 | 24                 | 23  | 22   | 20                  | 1                   |

|         |    |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |   |
|---------|----|-----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|---|
|         |    |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |   |
| 1 year  | 75 | ... | 54 | 51 | 50 | 47 | 47 | 45 | 44 | 43 | 42 | 40 | 3 |
| 3 years | 85 | ... | 76 | 75 | 75 | 74 | 74 | 73 | 73 | 72 | 72 | 71 | 7 |

Prior committed P (2026-09-22\_draft, light daily touch, auto-stamped): 1 / 1 / 14 / 33 / 66 · Prior committed P (2026-09-23\_draft, light daily touch, auto-stamped, RE-RATED UP): 3 / 3 / 16 / 35 / 66 · Current P (2026-09-23\_draft, light daily touch, auto-stamped, RE-RATED UP): 3 / 3 / 16 / 35 / 66 · not a direction: President Trump's Sept 22 UN General Assembly address — which yesterday's cycle scored the same-day Witkoff/Kushner-Araghchi meeting but never mentioned — put a deal "right after the election." The midterms

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

**P** — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. **THIS CYCLE (Sept 14, LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-15\_draft): RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from the Sept 13-committed 3/3/18/38/70). The regional meeting that was to be held on Monday in Salalah, in order to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue." **No new date was set.** Corroborated by Arab News, the WTC confirmed participation, and the UAE had already downgraded to a minister of state rather than its foreign minister. Iran's MFA spokesman says Saudi Arabia requested the postponement. The Houthis survive: FM Araqchi said Sept 13 that the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz" (Tehran Times / Mehr — Iranian state media quoting Iran's own foreign minister). **(+2.8%, \$107.54 November)** and WTI **\$102.34 (+2.3%)**. **A note on what was checked and rejected:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Salalah and Duqm ports; those are dated 10/1/26. The flip-line framework, charts drawn and draft joint statement prepared, survives the postponement and Oman's FM publicly recommitted to dialogue), 36mo 70 flat.

**Prior cycle (Sept 12, FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-12\_draft2): RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from the Sept 12-committed 1/2/18/38/70). Four paragraphs (which already covered the Sept 10-11 Bab al-Mandeb/Mayyun Island seizure and the Sept 10 UKMTO Warning 133-26 near Khasab): **Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kidnapping of two Saudi nationals** — the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes. PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing a fire (Reuters, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com), with satellite imagery showing fire/smoke at pumping stations near Al Mesba'ah and Al Dhekra. Iraq's PM ordered a probe of the Maysan oil field. Iran has claimed responsibility; President Trump, speaking in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a SINGLE, HEDGED, UNCONFIRMED statement, logged as exactly that, NOT as established fact. The theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province, so this is escalation within an existing theater, not a new one; the US-casualty clause does NOT fire — no confirmed US military casualties. **not scored:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled to the administration they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance. Iran, and UAE) voicing "deep concern over the continued escalation," calling for "exercising maximum restraint," and expressing concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mile from Khasab (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge); no new UKMTO warning was found beyond the already-logged Warning 133-26. **Sizing:** a third distinct and modest further move given the persistent-pattern read — but it is a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty, so sized small: 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat (a room reasoned. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of move size — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for review.**

**Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily, score set 2026-09-12\_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from the Sept 11-committed 1/4/20/40/71). **BEARISH and NEW: a second global escalation** (Bab al-Mandeb), continued an offensive that by Sept 11 captured Dhubab and Murad — the final coastal towns held by the internationally recognized Yemeni government — giving Iran-aligned Houthis control. This is confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald) and is materially more severe than the "closing in" status the Sept 10 cycle priced. President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting-data support offered instead) — a genuine US-restraint data point, logged as an honest counterweight. For so that clause does not fire either — this is a continuation/severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment (the direct-US-strikes and sustained-Brent clauses both fired in prior cycle). Unidentified projectiles struck two vessels roughly 4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire; corroborated by 3+ independent outlets (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill). **Logged but not scored.** Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session (Sept 12 settle ~\$104.61, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the flip-line clause that already fired in prior cycle. Control is a bigger step than the routine daily tanker-strike grind of the past week, sized moderately larger than recent 1-point touches but still restrained since no flip-line newly fires — the score is so **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped\_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

**Prior cycle (Sept 11, score set 2026-09-11\_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from the Sept 10-committed 1/5/22/42/72). **BEARISH and NEW — a second, distinct further escalation** (third consecutive session: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday — its highest in nearly four months, since May 19 — with WTI closing at \$102.34, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back. *Correction to the prior cycle:* that cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, logged Brent at ~\$101.25 "Thursday Sept 10" — an intraday read; The Hill — tankers, the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — clause does not fire either. **Logged but NOT used to move P (single-source):** a compilation putting Hormuz throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day average of 10-13 commodities. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5→4, 6mo 22→20, 12mo 42→40, 36mo 72→71.** A clause of this pillar's own flip line firing is a real escalation. The outlet bar and verification passed clean, so **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped\_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

**Prior cycle (Sept 10, score set 2026-09-10\_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from the Sept 9-committed 1/6/23/43/72). Two new dated facts. **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31), so since Sept 4 — a separate low-quality aggregator claiming a fresh KIA figure was checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own no-casualties statement). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), clearing the sufficiency bar. This is "closing in on" and "threatening" control, not as having executed a blockade — so it does not independently fire a flip-line clause either. Separately, Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100 intraday cross, but still short of a clean multi-session "sustained" call by this pillar's own conservative standard; flagged as the closest this cycle has come to the flip line and worth close watching, priced without crossing any flip-line threshold. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 6→5, 6mo 23→22, 12mo 43→42, 36mo held at 72** (a repeat requirement). **FINAL NUMBER's** call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

**Prior to this cycle (Sept 9, score set 2026-09-09\_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from the Sept 8-committed 1/7/24/44/73). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** **Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the Strait of Hormuz** — CENTCOM confirms both Iranian missile attempts were evaded and no US personnel were harmed — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired — and this is a repeat pattern confirmed by CNBC ("Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries") and ABC News, trading ~\$100.44, +2.57% — but this is a single-day intraday cross, not this "zone" announcement (already logged in the Sept 8 baseline as a not-yet-executed threat) remains in the same state — coverage today still describes boundaries as unspecified/forthcoming, so modest per-cycle cuts. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 7→6, 6mo 24→23, 12mo 44→43, 36mo 73→72.** This is a light daily touch, no window moved, delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

**Prior to this cycle (Sept 8, score set 2026-09-08\_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from the Sept 6-committed 1/8/25/45/73). **BEARISH and NEW: Iran's SNS** **the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf, with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list.** He separately said an Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be a record statement — clearing the sufficiency bar. It is a genuine new escalatory signal, but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details but-not-yet-executed escalatory statements (e.g. Trump's Aug 31 "still weighing further strikes" comment), this is sized as a small continuation-of-escalation cut, not a flip-line event: DCAS US GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) blockade count of 92 vessels redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced blockade-enforcement (the operative arrangement). **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 8→7, 6mo 25→24, 12mo 45→44, 36mo held at 73** (a shipping-zone threat doesn't count). **call band did not flip** (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

**Prior to this cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-06\_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** (from the Sept 5-committed 1/9/27/47/74). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** release (centcom.mil, corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets) states US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Dornier at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer); both ships evaded multiple attacks, no American personnel were harmed. Admiral Brad Cooper, CENTCOM's commander, Iran's Tasnim state-media claim, with AP framing it as an accusation and CENTCOM silent) — it is now primary-sourced and multiply corroborated, and it reveals a materially more serious escalation: "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone in the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera's live blog, Euronews) are IRGC's own claims only — not yet US-confirmed, so per the sufficiency rule they are NOT counted, no widening to a further new state (Kharg Island, Jask, and the Gulf of Oman are all existing theater), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (US/UK markets closed Saturday) — still a light daily touch. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1.** This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the market is stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."

**Prior to this cycle: P was RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** (Sept 2, committed Sept 3, then HELD FLAT through Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE repeat-target strikes and the Sept 5 full weekly update). **2026 under Alex's widened daily auto-stamp policy. BEARISH and CONFIRMED, the load-bearing new fact: the conflict escalated materially Sept 1-2, confirming exactly the risk this pillar** ship cruise-missile/drone launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike (multi-source: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI). For the first time in this war, the US struck a 5% Tuesday Sept 1 — its best session in 5 weeks — to ~\$95-96.6/bbl, WTI to ~\$91-92, still short of the \$100 flip line. A US strike on Kuhstak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reported. **NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level:** the casualty claim originates with Iranian state and local authorities, and CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither count as multi-sourcing the fact itself). It is reported here as context for what it triggered: Iran's IRGC launched coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 at US-linked bases in FOUR countries earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28 and Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points since Feb-Jul 2026 per this war's own tracker pages), so the pillar's own "widening to a FURTHER escalation" (roughly two dozen drones intercepted), and no confirmed new US combat death has been found as of this run — so neither the casualty clause nor the widening clause independently fires either. **on-record threatening larger future action:** President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military source told press Tehran's Reuters 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. **Originally left as draft Sept 2, not auto-stamped, for three reasons:** (1) the wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political scale jump (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker strikes) is a genuinely novel escalation beyond this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedent; (3) both sides' on-record threats of much more, which under the then-current rules disqualified auto-stamp on its own. **On September 3, 2026, Alex reviewed this cycle and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band change, only the stamping threshold changed. COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.** See My Decision below for the full reasoning.

**Prior to this cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up): P was RE-RATED DOWN to 7/15/32/50/75** (from the Aug 31-committed 9/17/34/51/75) — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority. **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** night is not yet a sustained new campaign" — that assumption is undercut by what happened next. A THIRD Hormuz tanker was hit Aug 31: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity, struck and reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents. Iran's army (not IRGC) claimed a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base, approaching from Iran — a disputed target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion, a genuine (if unconfirmed-as-a-hit) attempt to widen beyond the repeat-target Jordan pattern to further strikes on Iran, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicitly not signaling de-escalation. Brent crude continued higher into the night, confirmed US casualty, and no confirmed hit on UAE territory (UAE denies), so this does NOT independently fire a fresh flip-line clause on its own — neither the "confirmed new US combat death" nor hence the small move, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold: 1mo 9→7, 3mo 17→15, 6mo 34→32, 12mo 51→50, 36mo 75→75 (flat). Corroborated across CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, and others, Hormuz after observing preparations to fire sea mines into the strait — CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins confirmed on the record, corroborated by 20+ independent outlets (Bloomberg, Reuters, etc.) — a strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-consecutive-clean-night streak the Aug 29 baseline explicitly cited as part of its bullish case, and it directly fired this pillar's own pre-cycle IRGC confirmed Iranian soldiers/civilians killed or wounded at Larak (no precise toll given) and retaliated hours later, into Aug 31, with ballistic missiles at two US-linked airbases in Jordan (King Abdullah II Air Base, not scored as fact. That cut was front-loaded and held under 8 points per window, sized similarly to the Jul 28 Jordan-strike precedent for a comparable single-incident shock: 19-20 points). **CONFIRMED: the "Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24.** Directly fetched from home.treasury.gov: press release sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign to Isolate Iran's Economy"). Compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels were designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, and elsewhere. crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed. Unlike the sanctions this pillar tracked in prior cycles as "promised but not landed" (Bessent's rhetoric through Aug 22), this is a new, fired this window: Aug 24 off Oman (engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire, extinguished, crew safe, UKMTO) — both comparable in severity to the already-executed Iranian sea mines from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for inspection (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range (Oman's own government site) — a genuine upgrade, because in every prior cycle only Iran claimed a Hormuz deal and Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the statement, the "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/rate was excluded from scoring, same treatment as prior single-source claims. Trump declared the Strait "demined" with a zero-tolerance policy on new mines Aug 25 (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News, etc.). US News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-primary shipping data, 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42); still a small fraction (~1% of weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further away from the \$100/bbl flip line, with press explicitly framing it as "war premium unwinding" and the standing casualty total, not a new event) — the flip line remains unfired. No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th day of no strikes. Hormuz deal holding a full clean week without a new attack/fatality/seizure — is NOT met, since the Aug 27 attack breaks the "clean week" clause and the corridor deal remains Iran+Oman only.

**Quality** — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle's load-bearing fact — the Petrolina pipeline drone strike — is corroborated by a primary Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs statement plus multiple other sources used to move P. The prior cycle's load-bearing fact — the Bab al-Mandeb chokepoint seizure — remains corroborated across 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The New York Times, etc.). Rules: 0.60/0.65/0.70/0.65/0.55 for 1/3/6/12/36mo.

**Impact** — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14, firming from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13 and \$77,269.22 on Sept 12. Either way. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 — the real, visible risk-off pullback logged when this pillar's evidence last moved sharply negative.

## The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 16, 2026 (light daily touch, P re-rated down on the 6/12/36mo windows as the nuclear track escalates alongside the shooting war)

**This cycle (Sept 16):** the crowd's attention today is almost entirely on the CLARITY Act vote failure, not Iran — but two real, dated escalatory facts landed this week on the nuclear track that this treating this as real but bounded — a parliamentary push and an institutional referral are documented facts, not a completed NPT exit, and Pezeshkian's own public no-nukes line plus the Foreign 1mo/3mo, which were already sitting at this pillar's floor of 1 with no room left to express further deterioration. The shooting-war facts this pillar has tracked for weeks — the Saudi pipeline, the

**Prior cycle (Sept 12, full weekly refresh):** the crowd will likely either read the Petroline pipeline strike as proof Iran is now hitting Saudi Arabia's core oil-export infrastructure directly, or dismiss soil hit a NEW kind of target (Saudi Arabia's primary Hormuz-bypass export artery, not a refinery this time) for the third time this week, and that pattern — not the unconfirmed attribution — is a load-bearing fact is a single infrastructure strike with no widening (Iraq is already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike) and no US casualty — not because I am siding with either the "Iran" that only reports escalation isn't honest either.

**Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily):** the crowd will likely either treat the Bab al-Mandeb island seizures as a headline-grabbing new front that should crater risk assets, or dismiss it as "just Yemen" background chokepoint-controlling islands in a SECOND global oil corridor, not merely "closing in" on one, and that upgrades the standing risk even though no clause in this pillar's own flip line technically fits isn't one by this pillar's own pre-declared, falsifiable definitions — and I'd rather be criticized for under-reacting to a real structural shift than for inventing a new flip-line clause after the fact to justify

**Prior cycle (Sept 11):** the crowd will read a \$108 print and a 6% up-day in Brent as the war finally repricing energy — or, watching Friday's 3% give-back on Hormuz diplomacy headlines, wave the including a close above \$107, is that clause firing, not a near-miss. I said so in the two prior cycles when it hadn't fired yet; the discipline only counts if it also fires when the number arrives. What a service member. So this is a further modest cut, not a regime change — and the give-back on diplomacy headlines is logged honestly alongside it.

**Prior cycle (Sept 10):** the crowd is likely to either read the Al Azraq missile barrage as a dangerous new peak of the conflict, or wave off a Yemeni port city changing hands as background noise to since Jul 28, and both CENTCOM and Jordan's own military confirm no casualties this time either — a repeat-pattern event, not a new category. The Houthis seizure of Mocha is more interesting if global chokepoint is a genuine structural development worth flagging even though no blockade has actually been executed yet. Brent trading above \$100 for a second straight session is the more (1/5/22/42/72, from 1/6/23/43/72), consistent with the sizing this pillar has used for every cycle since Sept 6.

**Prior cycle (Sept 9):** the crowd is likely to either read Brent's intraday \$100 cross as confirmation the flip line has effectively fired, or dismiss the 5-tanker CENTCOM strike as "more of the same" rather than thing as a sustained close above \$100, which is what this pillar's own pre-declared threshold requires — so it does not independently fire that clause, though it earns a mention in every relevant source (Gulf of Oman, Kharg Island) responding to the same kind of provocation (an IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship) — a continuation of an already-priced trajectory, not a new category of event.

**Prior cycle (Sept 8):** the crowd is likely to either dismiss Rezaei's restricted-zone announcement as Iran "talking tough" without follow-through, or treat it as an imminent full closure of a new strategy yet an executed act — no boundaries, no enforcement mechanism, and no confirmed incident tied to it as of this cycle's research cutoff. Re-rating down modestly (1/7/24/44/73, from 1/8/25/45/74) for treatment of announced-but-unexecuted escalatory statements. I am explicitly not treating Rezaei's parallel claim that an Iran-Oman corridor deal will also be signed "in the coming days" as bullish.

**Prior cycle (Sept 6):** the crowd was likely to read CENTCOM's own confirmation of the Sept 5 tanker strike as a relief ("finally, official clarity") rather than what it actually was — a confirmation that destroying three tankers. Re-rated down modestly (1/8/25/45/73, from 1/9/27/47/74) rather than sharply, because none of this pillar's flip-line clauses fired on it (no US casualty, no new state, Brent new category of event. Sept 6's separate IRGC claims of further tanker/vessel/drone strikes were explicitly not used to move P — those are Iran's own claims, unconfirmed by the US, and the sufficient.

**The crowd:** is likely to anchor on the wedding-strike casualty claim as the emotional center of today's news, and either (a) treat it as a confirmed atrocity driving the story, or (b) dismiss the whole independently, multi-source confirmed regardless of how the casualty dispute resolves, and is the real story this cycle.

**Me:** cutting sharply to 1/9/27/47/74, versus the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped). This is the largest single-cycle P move this pillar has made since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut, a casualty fact — the political and emotional driver of today's four-country Iranian retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced at the level that matters (Iranian state/local authorities, CENTCOM neither resting partly on that; (2) the scale jump — ~50x the Aug 30 strike, plus the war's first direct tanker strikes — is a genuinely novel escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents (Jul 25) sides are now on-record threatening much larger responses ahead — a miscalibrated cut here is more costly than usual given what could follow. That said, the cut is still evidence-bounded, not pure.

**My edge:** the discipline here is refusing to let a single-source emotional fact do more work than it's earned, in either direction — not discarding it (it's genuinely the trigger for today's retaliation) but support on their own. The crowd either over- or under-reacts to a claim like this; this pillar tries to size around it instead.

**Honesty check against the tape:** BTC fell from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp) to \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own sharp drop explicitly as an honesty check for the reader.

## The Facts

As of September 19, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-19, draft). Hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New facts from this cycle appear first; earlier facts are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing) below.

### ★ NEW THIS CYCLE — THE WEEK OF SEPTEMBER 19–26, 2026

★ **THE LOAD-BEARING NEW FACT — Iran's foreign minister put a concrete plan on the record, Sept 25, 2026.** FM Abbas Araghchi, speaking to reporters *outside the UN Security Council* and observes a ceasefire on all fronts including Lebanon and Yemen; **the Strait of Hormuz reopens on day six**; and **US–Iran talks on a final nuclear deal begin on day seven**. In his words: *on the record*, carried by AP, Reuters and Al Jazeera as independent originals — a categorical upgrade over the anonymous sourcing that this pillar has repeatedly refused to score. *Sourcing per Material context, in his own words:* Araghchi framed the US steps as not new — "They are all already in the MOU" — which ties the plan to the existing Islamabad framework rather than presumes

★ **NEW — Pezeshkian offers to readmit UN nuclear inspectors, in a CBS excerpt released Sept 25.** Asked whether Iran would allow UN nuclear inspectors back in, President Pezeshkian said *full Sunday, Sept 27 broadcast*, not a Sept 25 interview aired in full; the concession is explicitly **conditional on the US accepting Iran's proposal**; and the softening versus his own defiant Sept 25 accepting the language of force." Even so, inspector access is the first movement on the nuclear file in weeks, and it is the specific reason the 12-month window takes +1.

★ **NEW — Secretary Rubio on the record, Sept 24:** the previous day's talks were "largely positive" and "human beings talked to each other yesterday," but he *declined* to call it a breakthrough.

★ **CORRECTION to the Sept 23 committed set — the Sept 22 contact was MEDIATED, not direct.** That set called it the "first direct-channel" US–Iran contact. Witkoff's own on-record account **divergence is disclosed rather than smoothed over:** Iranian state broadcaster IRIB described it as a *meeting* between Araghchi and Witkoff held at Witkoff's request, and Trump said his envoys

★ **FALSIFIED CLAIM — a cargo vessel WAS struck in Hormuz on Sept 23.** The abandoned Sept 24 draft stated that "no new tanker incidents dated Sept 23–24 were found." That is **wrong**, the crew evacuated, with **two casualties** reported. **Careful wording, because the sources genuinely do not say more:** UKMTO did *not* state whether the two casualties were killed or injured (one Indian national killed, 19 Indian nationals aboard) — not to UKMTO. Either way these are **merchant crew, not US service members**, so the US-combat-death flip line is untouched. *Basist* primary-verified.

★ **NEW — two Houthi salvos at Saudi Arabia.** On **Sept 24** Saudi forces intercepted **six ballistic missiles** aimed at Taif and the Yanbu Red Sea area; overnight **Sept 25–26** the coalition intercepted **widening clause:** Saudi Arabia is a repeat target already in theatre, and everything incoming was intercepted.

★ **NEW STATE OF AFFAIRS — no announced US strike on Iranian territory since Sept 1, roughly 3.5 weeks.** The strikes clause that fired Aug 30 is therefore now **DORMANT, though not** under US and Partner Military Operations) plus the absence of wire coverage — wire/ISW-derived, not primary-verified. A discrepancy is flagged rather than printed: secondary sources date the

★ **US fatalities — the flip line did NOT fire, with three corrections to the record.** The Pentagon's DCAS total stands at **19**, unchanged through Sept 26, and breaks down as **11 hostile plus 8** the Army says non-combat-related and a defense official described a medical incident aboard a flight to Saudi Arabia. It is explicitly non-hostile, so this pillar's flip line, which requires a confirmed investigation reportedly claims more US troops have died than the Pentagon has disclosed; the article returned 403 and could not be read. It is potentially material to this flip line and needs a

★ **MARKET PRICES AND SHIPPING DATA — labelled, never presented as institutional estimates.** Brent closed **\$106.60 on Sept 24, up 3.4%**, with an intraday high of **\$108.23**, then closed **\$107.23** on Sept 25, with an intraday high of **\$108.23** and a low of **\$106.60**, then closed **\$107.23** on Sept 26, with an intraday high of **\$108.23** and a low of **\$106.60**. **Hormuz transits show no recovery:** Reuters shipping data has transits falling to **nine on Thursday Sept 24** from 14 the previous day, against a **10-day average** of **14**. *Methodology trap avoided:* an IMF PortWatch reading of one transit is dated Sept 20 *and* uses PortWatch's own 85/day baseline, so it is not comparable with the Reuters series and the two are of the Sept 19 CENTCOM briefing lineage). Prediction-market quotes on a US–Iran ceasefire are excluded entirely this cycle: the market definitions conflate Israel–Iran with US–Iran, so no number

★ **REPORTED BUT EXPLICITLY NOT SCORED — and the most important one cuts AGAINST this cycle's up-move. (a)** The Wall Street Journal reported Sept 25–26, citing *unnamed US officials* **original-source:** Bloomberg, CNBC, The Hill, JPost, Ynet and others all headline it as a *WSJ report*, and there is **no on-record White House confirmation** anywhere as of Sept 26. WSJ's own claim to move a P — **and this report applies that rule symmetrically: the item argues for a smaller up-move or none, and is still not used. (b)** The National's Sept 23 "road map" remains single-**Pakistani and Egyptian mediation versus seven days via Qatar** — and the two are deliberately **not merged. (c)** An IRGC claim of a cluster-warhead anti-ship missile test near a US carrier (Sept 25)

- ★ ★ **NEW** — the **UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing, Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) on Sept 18, 2026 to renew the panel of independent experts monitoring** new fact on the ground, so it doesn't move P.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Trump told Axios (Sept 17, 2026) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a planned Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly** (5+ independent). Rhetoric about an undated future decision, not an action — this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.
- ★ ★ **CORROBORATION UPDATE, reverses last cycle's "not fired" call:** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18, 2026 is now confirmed via the IRGC's own already-months-long tanker campaign, not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — the **IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council.** A primary institutional action by the IAEA itself, escalating international
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for Iran's withdrawal from the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty** (outlets, though two are Iranian state-affiliated, so treated as corroborated reporting of a documented parliamentary act rather than independent Western confirmation).
- **Counterweight, same sourcing set:** President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons, even as the parliamentary push proceeds. Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail
- **Nothing new found** on the Salalah Iran-GCC ministerial (still postponed, no new date), the Saudi East-West pipeline (still offline), or Hormuz shipping beyond what the Sept 15 baseline already

Carried forward from the September 12 full weekly refresh and the daily touches since — still load-bearing, not contradicted:

- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi M** were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com — 6+ independent).
- **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility for the pipeline strike; the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state. Pres
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province); the US-casualty clause does NO
- **Counterweight, logged:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, co
- for "exercising maximum restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, long-horizon diplomatic data point (1yr/3yr framing only), not used to move P.
- **Re-verified independently:** the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) still holds, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, Z

Carried forward from the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12\_draft, auto-stamped — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab and Murad by Sept 11, the last government-held coastal towns) and seize M** (NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Yemen is existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire.
- **Counterweight, logged:** Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused — intelligence/targeting-data support of
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10) confirms four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire** (Gulf M
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** IRGC's own claim to have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM c
- **Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session** (settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the already-fired "sustained >\$100" fl
- **BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14** — up 1.4% from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13, which itself eased from \$77,269.22 on Sept 12 (local run.py quant refresh).
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD** — the **"sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday** (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics Sept 10-11, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent). Three consecutive sessions above \$100, two of them confirmed closes and on
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shi** is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire.
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** a compilation of Hormuz transit data puts throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day moving average of 10-13 commodity vess
- **Counterweight, logged:** Friday Sept 11's ~3% Brent give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around the Strait of Hormuz and to the IEA's forecast of a 2.5 mb/d contraction in 2026 dem
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD** — **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, in retaliation for the Sept 8 five-tanker s** sufficiency bar. Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does not fire.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, a SECOND global shipping chokep** no strait closure or interdiction has actually been confirmed — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on," not as having executed a blockade.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session**, more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 sustained call).
- **NEW** — **no widening to a further new state and no confirmed US casualty:** Jordan is a repeat target, and CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties from the Al Azraq strike; DCAS rem
- **BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11** — down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local full quant refresh this cycle, run.py quant).

Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW** — **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T D** (SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") — clears the sufficiency bar.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24**, trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as U closest this cycle has come to it).
- **NEW** — **both Iranian missile attempts on the US Navy warship were evaded, no US personnel harmed** — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired.
- **NEW** — **no widening to a further new state:** Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are both existing theater already struck in this war.
- **Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains not-yet-executed** — no new dated development, not re-scored a second time.
- **BTC traded at \$79,052.40 on Sept 9** — up from \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 and \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beyond the Strait of Hormuz "in the coming days."** The zone would be The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced." Rezaei separately said an I
- **GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) tracker puts the blockade count at 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded** — up from Day 190's 87/3/2 (Sept 3), a continuation of the already-pr
- **BTC traded at \$78,435.62 on Sept 8** — down from \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 and \$80,338.98 on Sept 6 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5, resolving the tanker report this pillar had withheld p** IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which evaded multiple attacks with no American personnel harmed. Corrobor
- ★ **This revealed a materially more serious escalation than the Sept 5 baseline knew:** not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels a
- **Sept 6's IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remain US-unconfirmed as of this cyc

- ★ **BTC traded at \$79,929.30 on Sept 6** — up from \$79,646.11 on Sept 5 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak Island strike.** Targets included IRGC air-defense sites, radar installations, and other military infrastructure.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy** — confirmed by multiple sources.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1, its best session in 5 weeks, to ~\$95-96.6/bbl; WTI to ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ ★ **NEW, FLAGGED SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED — a US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party.** The Hormozgan governor's office denied it. The casualty claim itself originates with Iranian state/local authorities — wide Western-outlet pickup of that one narrative is not the same as independent multi-sourcing of the event.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait.** Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points Feb-Jul 2026), so the "widening to a FURTHER NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT fire.
- ★ **NEW — most projectiles were intercepted:** Jordan (~10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed, no reported casualties); Bahrain (most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted). No confirmed new US strikes.
- ★ **NEW — both sides now on-record threatening larger future action:** President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military official threatened further strikes.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01\_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles, follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents — the third such hit in the same window.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES that base was targeted while CONFIRMING a separate cross-border drone incursion.** Intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iran. So: a disputed target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion — reported via CBS News.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran,** calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicit threat of escalation.
- ★ **Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports)** on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle.
- ★ **Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31,** but remained a repeat, not a "further new," state per this pillar's own framing (already struck Jul 28 and again as part of the Aug 30 IRGC retaliation) — confirmed by multiple sources.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31\_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers, confirmed by NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, and Time. The first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since the 2020 thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement plus multi-source reporting.** IRGC said it struck two airbases, beyond the interception — logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. IRGC separately confirmed Iranian soldiers/civilians killed or wounded at Larak (no precise toll given).
- ★ **Press (Reuters/CNBC) framed the renewed exchange as weighing on Asian equities and US futures,** reversing the prior two-week Brent decline.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 on Aug 31** — up from \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29\_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov.** Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iran's Oil and Banking Sector") compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and TRON were listed. Unlike prior cycles' "promised but not landed" sanctions rhetoric, this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. Continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Mellat listing.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle, the Oman revenue-sharing deal is single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded.
- ★ **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents.** Aug 24, off Oman's coast (engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO); Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished).
- ★ **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28** (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian vessels disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed. Read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a fresh shock.
- ★ **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead** (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the highest toll since the 2020 crisis.
- ★ **NEW — Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack.
- ★ **NEW — the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23** (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-confirmed baseline, but a genuine first uptick).
- ★ **NEW — Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further from the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ **NEW — no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29** (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the 2020 tally).
- ★ **NEW — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found** — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.
- ★ **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28\_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents and TRM Labs' Iran-linked vessel list.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22\_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" (19 deaths across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East (possibly including a separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike that killed 6, per Al Jazeera), not the Hormuz crisis).
- ★ **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline.
- ★ **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) described a missile strike on a UAE oil tanker, Jazeera, Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance describing one event. Iran's foreign ministry denies responsibility, calling it a possible "false flag" incident.
- ★ **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.
- ★ **The Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remained unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a confirmed deal.
- ★ **Brent was ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21,** a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — now reversed by this cycle's two-week Brent decline above.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagreed on the exact daily transit count as of Aug 22** (estimates ranged ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22\_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulk carrier was corroborated by 7+ independent outlets (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247). No claim of responsibility yet. **Re-verified this cycle (draft2)** — no new information, and a reason this cycle is left as a draft rather than auto-stamped.

- ★ ★ **NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker Amara was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under Iranian law.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE's shipping.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.
- **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to the State Department.
- **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war."
- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile hit the Abu Dhabi coast.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent of the missile claim; *embargo was initially flagged as a possible second incident by this cycle's adversarial pass — confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode, not a new one.*
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplayed the claim, rather than "very close." Trump told reporters he has "no time schedule" to resolve the conflict (a framing he softened, per above, on Aug 19).
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd handle it" through the Strait.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM says 10-15; *cycle; the more defensible figure is closer to ~110/day. The discrepancy is flagged here for transparency; it does not change the direction or size of the collapse, which is stark under either baseline.*
- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, npr.org); the UAE Foreign Ministry called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties at the time — now compounding into the Aug 18 shipping-collapse picture above.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent sources) report a US demand for compensation to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Gaza" — a hardening of the same dispute, not a new demand category.
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure — still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, BBC).
- ★ **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government; an ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible direct impact.
- ★ **Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9,** a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent sources).

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com) says the deal depends on further conditions, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer acceptable to Tehran."
- ★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting the Strait.

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying 30,000 tonnes of gas (Aug 3); two more explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident tally now stands at 65 since the war began (Bloomberg/UANI), with Hormuz traffic described as "at risk."
- ★ ★ **NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7,** wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns).
- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that complicates the regional picture.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping,** banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA). The fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News (Iranian state media, citing one parliamentarian) and should be labeled Iran-sourced, not Omani.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called for more announcements paired with continuing attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed terms.

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle" was reached (Military.com).
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants 10%.

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on the pause — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first meeting.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump: "I don't know."
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iransitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was being discussed.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an agreement on the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization of a deal.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — but the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, and Basra — Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia officials) — flagged, not used.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel).
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the lull.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly contradicting the Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one 68-32 (all Dems) is still pending.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced July 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, JCRC, and US Navy all confirm.
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~**\$98,225 intraday low**, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't started.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia-Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended ~**+25-28%** by Mar 10, 2022. The Aug 30-Sept 2 direct US-Iran exchange escalated sharply (a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, a four-country Iranian retaliation), reset the market, but has not been confirmed reopened either. As of this cycle (Sept 19), the picture is mixed rather than clearly escalating further: Iran has gone nine straight days without strikes, but the US has not. BTC traded at **\$81,224.46** on Sept 19, up sharply from \$78,046.80 on Sept 18 — this pillar's own P held flat this cycle, so that move tracks other pillars' news (notably nothing that cleared any of the upside case). The upside case is unchanged in shape: a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept, signed and holding a full clean week without a new attack, fatality, or seizure, the nearest dated event that could move this either way — the Prize doesn't feed the math, it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of magnitude from the worst-case scenario this pillar has always flagged as the real tail risk, and that keeping the cut "under 8 points per window" mechanically, out of habit from smaller prior incidents, is itself a mistake.
- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, but the single-source caveat as an excuse to soften a call the non-disputed facts already support, rather than a genuine evidentiary gap.
- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a materially larger cut than a routine tanker incident, precisely because the report itself said in advance this class of event was different in kind, not just degree.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign or further strikes follow in the next few days, this cut may prove to have moved faster than the evidence ultimately warranted.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" side have fundamentally 1mo/3mo-scoped shock.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets as a target.
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a reader should not expect it.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchange could reset the trend.
- **Two more restraint signals landed this cycle, logged honestly — a reader could argue they're under-weighted.** The BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) — signed by Saudi Arabia — describes the Houthis privately signaling they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen. Neither moves P (one is purely diplomatic, the other single-source as to substance), but this pillar looms large even when each individual scoring decision is defensible.

## The Triggers

dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. **As of Sept 19 (full weekly refresh):** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike is now CONFIRMED (reversing the Sept 18 NOT USED call, but not moving P — see (new row below); and the UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel — institutional gridlock, a new row below. None of this clears the sufficiency bar; P HELD FLAT. **As of Sept 18:** Trump's IAEA's UNSC referral (Sept 9) and the 130-lawmaker NPT-withdrawal push (Sept 12-13) are the newest entries, driving this cycle's 6/12/36mo re-rate down. Re-leveled August 22, 2026, refreshed August 29: **this pillar's own downsides** materially larger strike wave and a four-country retaliation; the Sept 5 tanker strike is CENTCOM-CONFIRMED and revealed to be part of a direct IRGC missile attack on 2 US Navy warships; Iran's SNSC secretary announces intent to hit Jordan's Al Azraq air base Sept 9, and Houthi forces seize the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10 closing in on Bab el-Mandeb. **As of Sept 11 a SECOND, distinct flip-line clause has now fired** — the "sustained Brent close above \$100/bbl" condition is met, second global chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, though it does not independently fire a fresh flip-line (top row). **As of the Sept 13 light daily touch, the first de-escalation datapoint in the series** routes and mine clearance — the first such gathering since the war began in February (Iranian MFA statement, primary, plus 6+ independent outlets). It drives this pillar's first UPWARD re-rate since Aug 6, sized small by vessel attack near Qeshm Island, a Houthi projectile on Jazan, ongoing Bab al-Mandeb combat). It does NOT fire the upside flip line, which requires a signed, US-accepted Hormuz reopening holding a full clean sweep sponsorship undetermined (Trump's "probably Iran" is a single hedged remark) — neither the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires.

| DATE                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | EVENT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FIRE</b> Sept 25 — DE-ESCALATORY, named principal ON THE RECORD, 3 independent originals                                                                                                                             | <b>FM Abbas Araghchi detailed a SEVEN-DAY plan</b> outside the UN Security Council, conveyed to Washington via Qatar: ~4–5 days of US steps (lift of the estimated \$12bn in frozen assets, ceasefire on all fronts including Lebanon and Yemen), <b>Strait reopens day six</b> , nuclear talks begin day seven. "The AP, Reuters and Al Jazeera as independent originals. He added the US steps "are all already in the MOU"                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>FIRE</b> Sept 25 — DE-ESCALATORY, nuclear file, but <b>CONDITIONAL</b>                                                                                                                                               | <b>Pezeshkian offers to readmit UN nuclear inspectors</b> in a CBS excerpt released Sept 25 ahead of the Sunday Sept 27 broadcast: "That is absolutely whatever we commit to" — explicitly <i>if</i> the US accepts Iran's proposal. Materially softer than his own Sept 23 UNGA address <i>on inspector access speed</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>FIRE</b> Sept 23 — ESCALATORY, and it <b>FALSIFIES</b> the abandoned Sept 24 draft                                                                                                                                   | <b>A cargo vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait of Hormuz</b> , caught fire, lost control and drifted; crew evacuated; <b>two casualties</b> ; no incidents occurred Sept 23–24 — wrong. <b>UKMTO did not say killed or injured, so this report does not say "two killed"</b> ; the vessel is the Antioch <i>Dao</i> , and one confirmed fatality is attributed to the <b>Indian Embassy in Oman</b> (19 Indian nationals aboard). ukmt.o <span>rg</span> 403'd — wire-derived, not primary                                                                            |
| FIRE Sept 24 and overnight Sept 25–26 — escalatory, multi-source                                                                                                                                                        | <b>Two Houthi salvos at Saudi Arabia</b> : six ballistic missiles intercepted toward Taif and the Yanbu area (Sept 24); two more plus two drones toward Khamis Mushayt (Sept 25–26)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>DORMANT</b> as of Sept 26 — a previously fired clause has <b>lapsed</b>                                                                                                                                              | <b>No announced US strike on Iranian territory since SEPT 1</b> , roughly 3.5 weeks. centcom.mil returned 403 on both release indexes, so this negative is significant to report") plus the absence of wire coverage — <b>wire/ISW-derived, not primary-verified</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>STILL FIRE</b> — a flip-line clause, market price                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Brent remains well above \$100</b> : closed <b>\$106.60 Sept 24 (+3.4%, intraday high \$108.23)</b> , then <b>\$104.37 Sept 25 (–2.09%)</b> , ~+20% on the month — "\$99, two-week low, war premium unwinding" read                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| NOT FIRE — checked Sept 26, no recovery                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Hormuz transits</b> : nine on Thursday Sept 24 from 14 the previous day, <b>10-day average 18</b> , against a pre-war baseline of ~ <b>125</b> large commercial vessels; roughly <b>7–14% of normal</b> . An IMF PortWatch reading of 1 is dated Sept 20 and uses PortWatch's own 85/day baseline — <b>not comparable, and not a record</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>NOT FIRE</b> — the combat-death clause, with three record corrections                                                                                                                                                | <b>Pentagon DCAS holds at 19</b> through Sept 26 ( <b>11 hostile, 8 non-hostile</b> ). The 19th was <b>Capt.</b> Bianca C. Wilkerson, 37, <b>posthumously promoted to major</b> <b>cause as "undetermined," not "medical."</b> No new US combat death found                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>REPORTED, NOT SCORED</b> — and it argues <b>AGAINST</b> this cycle's up-move                                                                                                                                         | <b>The WSJ reported Sept 25–26, citing UNNAMED US officials, that Trump REJECTED the seven-day plan</b> and expects to resume bombing after Sept 27 — original-source: Bloomberg, CNBC, The Hill, JPost and Ynet all cite the WSJ; <b>no on-record White House confirmation exists</b> . WSJ's own caveat: Trump "could change again"                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| REPORTED, NOT SCORED — still single-original-source                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>The National's Sept 23 60-day "road map"</b> : Semafor attributes it verbatim to "The National reported" rather than confirming independently. It is a <b>60-day</b> — 60 days with Qatari/Pakistani/Egyptian mediation versus seven days via Qatar                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| WATCH — the next concrete signal either way                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Whether the US responds ON THE RECORD to the seven-day plan</b> . Rubio called the Sept 24 talks "largely positive" but explicitly not a breakthrough. The IRGC said Sept 25 it "will not stop punishing the US until Iran's seven conditions are met"                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| FIRE Sept 24 (event dated Sept 22) — on-record, multi-sourced, this cycle                                                                                                                                               | <b>President Trump's UN General Assembly address, Sept 22, 2026</b> (Axios, NBC News, CBS News, Times of Israel, PBS, Bloomberg, Washington Post) — deal be made with Iran that lets them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before ... or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic, and we'll make a deal right after the election because it doesn't make sense for them not to. They're waiting to see how I do in the midterm election." N scored the same-day Witkoff/Kushner-Araghchi meeting but not the speech — that omission is logged, not folded in quietly |
| Sept 23 — REPORTED, NOT SCORED (single-narrative source)                                                                                                                                                                | <i>The National</i> (Sept 23) reported Iran presented the US a "road map": a regionwide ceasefire of up to 60 days, phased Strait of Hormuz reopening in 60 days, blockade, via Qatari, Pakistani and Egyptian mediators. Gulf News and Aaj English TV carry it but label it "report" in their own headlines — syndicated                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Sept 17, reported Sept 17-18; UPCOMING Tuesday Sept 22 — dated, multi-sourced (Axios original, plus Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News — 5+ independent) | <b>Trump told Axios he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime or not</b> , ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly address — Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Struck Sept 17-18 — CONFIRMED via IRGC's own statement (IRNA, primary, via GlobalSecurity.org reprint) plus independent outlets (The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, Rio Times)                            | The IRGC struck the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18; crew reported safe, no confirmed spill; no CENTCOM confirmed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Sept 7-13, still unenacted as of Sept 19 — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militari <span>y</span> , IFP News)                         | <b>Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal</b> : 130 lawmakers signed a further Sept 7-13 statement urging NPT withdrawal. Parliament Presidium spokesman Abbas Goudarzi said withdrawal "can easily" be done; a bill was submitted for expedited consideration but not yet enacted. Foreign Ministry says it is "still being prepared"                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Sept 18 — PRIMARY (UN press releases sc16455 and related) plus Euronews and Security Council Report's monthly forecast                                                                                                  | <b>The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing) to renew its panel of independent experts monitoring reimposed Iran sanctions</b> — Somalia and Pakistan abstaining, deepening the ongoing Russia/China-vs-E3 legal dispute over the 2025 "snapback" sanctions reimposition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>FIRE</b> Sept 9, reported Sept 12-16 — PRIMARY (IAEA Board of Governors institutional action)                                                                                                                        | <b>The IAEA Board of Governors voted to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council</b> , escalating international pressure over Iran's nuclear program — inspectors. Separately, 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for NPT withdrawal, with a bill is being drafted (RFE/RL, Tehran Times, Mehr News — 3 independent outlets). Counterweight: President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking NPT withdrawal. Ministry says the withdrawal bill "is still being prepared."                       |

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| <b>FIRE</b> d Sept 13 — <b>PRIMARY</b> (Oman News Agency statement) plus 5+ independent outlets (Arab News, Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News, Malay Mail)                                  | <b>The Salalah ministerial was POSTPONED, one day before it was to convene, with NO new date.</b> ONA: the meeting is “postponed to a later date conducive to a constructive dialogue.” Bahrain had explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed; the UAE had downgraded to a ministerial-level meeting; Iran had not responded; the UAE requested the delay citing Yemen and calls that a pretext — <i>single-party-sourced to Iranian officials, reported not scored</i> . Separately, FM Araqchi said the meeting was “postponed to a later date” — mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz” (Tehran Times/Mehr). Brent +2.8% past \$107, WTI \$102.34 — <i>market prices, reported not scored</i> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Announced Fri Sept 11, reported Sept 11-12 — PRIMARY</b> (Iranian MFA statement) plus 6+ independent outlets; <b>SUPERSEDED — the meeting was postponed Sept 13, see the row above</b> | <b>First Iran-GCC ministerial meeting since the war began in February.</b> The foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq convene in Salalah to discuss the security of the Persian Gulf — safe/temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-negotiations. The meeting is “postponed to a later date conducive to a constructive dialogue.” Bahrain had explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed; the UAE had downgraded to a ministerial-level meeting; Iran had not responded; the UAE requested the delay citing Yemen and calls that a pretext — <i>single-party-sourced to Iranian officials, reported not scored</i> . Separately, FM Araqchi said the meeting was “postponed to a later date” — mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz” (Tehran Times/Mehr). Brent +2.8% past \$107, WTI \$102.34 — <i>market prices, reported not scored</i> . |
| Sept 13, reported same day (Al Jazeera live blog) — Iran’s attribution is Iran’s own and is NOT treated as established                                                                    | A commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside the Strait of Hormuz, killing one and wounding four; an Iranian official blamed the “US Navy” for the attack. The vessel was carrying oil and was headed to Jazan, Saudi Arabia, causing injuries and damaging a mosque. Houthi forces and Yemen’s internationally recognised government continued trading in the Red Sea.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Friday Sept 11 — a market price, reported NOT used to move P                                                                                                                              | Brent gave back 4.24% to ~\$104.26, the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired; wire coverage attributes the drop to a demand-contraction forecast (TradingEconomics, Forbes)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Attack Sept 10, Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11 (primary) plus 6+ independent outlets — sponsorship UNDETERMINED (Iraqi-origin, no group claim)                                  | <b>Saudi Arabia’s East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory; near Riyadh/Medina struck, injuries and material damage, will not retaliate for now at Baghdad’s request</b> (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of India). The attack was “a significant escalation of the conflict in the region.” The pipeline is “one of the most important oil pipelines in the world.” Iraq’s PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, closed the Shalamcheh border crossing. Trump (Dublin): Iran “probably” responsible, but “unconfirmed, NOT treated as fact                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Fired Sept 10-11, escalated to island seizure Sept 11, CONFIRMED via 6+ independent outlets — no strait closure yet                                                                       | <b>Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen’s entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubbab, Murad) and seize Mayyun (Perim) Island in the process; will not retaliate for now at Baghdad’s request</b> (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS’s request for direct US strike on Houthi forces (intel/targeting support offered instead)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Sept 10 (UKMTO Warning 133-26, issued 1910 UTC), reported Sept 11 — CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus 3+ independent outlets                                                                       | <b>Four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire</b> (UKMTO; Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill). The attack was “a significant escalation of the conflict in the region.” The vessels were “commercial vessels” and “not carrying oil.” A separate IRGC claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance, no US/CENTCOM confirmation yet (single-source, IRGC claim only): a separate IRGC claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance, no US/CENTCOM confirmation yet                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>FIRE</b> d Sept 10-11 — a flip-line clause, CONFIRMED via 4+ independent market sources                                                                                                | <b>“Sustained Brent close above \$100” — Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 (above \$108 intraday), its highest since May; Brent still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, ~9% higher on the week</b> (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage). Brent “closed above \$100 for the first time since May.” Sessions above \$100. <i>Correction:</i> the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday’s level — an intraday read, not the close                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Fired Sept 9, fuller reporting landed Sept 10-11, CONFIRMED via 4 independent outlets (Reuters wire)                                                                                      | <b>Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by Iran since the start of the war; at least one seafarer killed, one missing</b> (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Fired Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM/Jordan’s own military statement plus multi-outlet reporting                                                                                           | <b>IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan’s Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base</b> — Jordan’s armed forces “fired 20 ballistic missiles at the air base” in “a retaliatory strike.” The base is “in a sparsely populated area, no casualties” (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan’s own military statement)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Fired Sept 10, CONFIRMED via 5+ independent outlets — chokepoint NOT yet closed                                                                                                           | <b>Iran-aligned Houthi forces seize the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait</b> — a SECOND global oil chokepoint. The Houthi forces “seized the city” and “closed the port.” The Strait of Hormuz (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Second straight session, logged Sept 10 — SUPERSEDED by the Sept 10-11 firing above                                                                                                       | <b>Brent crude trades near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session</b> — above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; the Sept 10 session “closed above \$100 for the first time since May.” Level, which proved to be an intraday read (Thursday closed above \$107)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Crossed intraday Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CNBC and ABC News — NOT a sustained close                                                                                                          | <b>Brent crude tops \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24</b> , trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil-supply worries. “Brent crude topped \$100 for the first time since July 24,” ABC News)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Fired Sept 8, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM’s own press release plus 5+ independent outlets                                                                                                       | <b>CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riese (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days</b> (“US Destroys 5 IRGC Carriers,” centcom.mil; NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org corroborating)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Announced Sept 6-7, on-record, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets — NOT yet executed                                                                                                  | <b>Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces Iran will declare a new “restricted zone” beginning at the US Navy’s blockade line and extending to the Strait of Hormuz</b> — “the zone will be declared in the coming days,” with any vessel entering it placed on Iran’s sanctions list; he separately says an Iran-Oman corridor agreement will be signed “in the coming days.” (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, Newsbytes, WFLA, GlobalSecurity.org)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Fired Sept 5, CONFIRMED Sept 6 via CENTCOM’s own press release plus 5+ independent outlets                                                                                                | <b>CENTCOM confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5 — M/T Downy (disabled, Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (disabled, Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships</b> (a carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which were “damaged” (centcom.mil; Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC corroborating)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Claimed Sept 6, single-source (IRGC) — NOT independently used to move P                                                                                                                   | <b>Iran’s IRGC claims further strikes on three more tankers plus three “US-linked” vessels, and a strike on a US naval drone entering the Strait of Hormuz</b> (Euronews)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Fired Sept 3, CONFIRMED — repeat targets, widening clause did NOT fire                                                                                                                    | <b>Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit</b> (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED via 9 independent outlets                                                                                                                                       | <b>CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran</b> — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti-ship missiles. “The strikes were a significant escalation of the conflict in the region.” 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak strike (Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED, novel                                                                                                                                                          | <b>For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms)</b> under a newly reported “tanker for tanker” policy (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Reported Sept 1-2, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — NOT independently used to move P                                                                                           | <b>A US strike on Kuhestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party</b> — Hormozgan governor’s office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. a 4-year-old), 6 injured. “The strike was a retaliatory strike for the Sept 8 strikes on US Navy warships.” Confirmed nor denied it                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Fired Sept 2, CONFIRMED via multi-source reporting — widening clause did NOT fire                                                                                                         | <b>IRGC coordinated ballistic-missile/drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait</b> — most projectiles “hit targets” (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Fired Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting                                                                                                                             | <b>A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week:</b> the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm northeast of Kharg Island (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) — no casualties — follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Claimed Aug 31, DISPUTED target / CONFIRMED incursion                                                                                                                                     | <b>Iran’s army claims a drone strike on the UAE’s Al Minhad Air Base; UAE MoD DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING it intercepted the drone</b> (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

|                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal                                          | <b>President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran</b> , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo)                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED                                                 | <b>Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory:</b> CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observing prep to fire strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Ha                                                                                   |
| Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)                  | <b>IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases</b> (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted 8 missiles; Iran US/Jordan beyond interception; no confirmed US casualty                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29                                 | <b>"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package</b> — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/individuals 13902 sectoral determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts; continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation |
| Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29                                 | <b>Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor</b> — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entry/exit) clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary;" no fee terms disclosed; "closed" pending US compliance                                                     |
| Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29                                                     | <b>Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents:</b> Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (UKMT); Aug 27, same-day, crew safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.                                                                                                                                            |
| Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable                                       | <b>Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined"</b> and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force surveillance (multiple corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability                                                                                                                         |
| Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29                                                        | <b>CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing:</b> Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~100 enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, etc.)                                                                                  |
| Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets                                 | <b>Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead</b> across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)                          | <b>First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis:</b> +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→40)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29                                   | <b>IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters</b> (Sepah News, Iranian state military source; via Reuters) — but Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with the spokesman said the US is "obstructing this process"                                   |
| Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker                                               | <b>28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event                                                     | <b>No new confirmed US combat death.</b> One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the prior week                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range     | <b>Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign:</b> bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar                           | <b>First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22:</b> tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle | <b>The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory</b> , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false alarm"                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural                                            | <b>The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved          | <b>The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned;</b> Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding                                           | <b>Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar                                           | <b>The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal;</b> Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened Aug 20)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named                           | <b>Trump threatened Oman</b> ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative                                                      | <b>Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits</b> vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far                                       | <b>A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait</b> , engine damage, one crew injury                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding                                | <b>Three ADNOC tanker incidents</b> (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation                                                | <b>Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden</b> (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Iran demands \$100B, UAE \$10B                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation                                    | <b>Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah</b> (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation                                      | <b>Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery</b> (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation                                               | <b>Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand;</b> UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks"                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks                                  | <b>Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents</b> (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally 19 dead                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front                                                  | <b>Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia</b> , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Pending — the real trigger                                                                    | <b>Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week</b> of no further escalation                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Structural, ongoing                                                                           | <b>Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance</b> plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

The flip line, re-leveled — TRIGGERED Aug 30, and as of Sept 11 a SECOND distinct clause (sustained Brent close above \$100) has now ALSO fired: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause fired — CENTCOM struck Larak Island, the first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29. As of Sept 11, the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause fired — CENTCOM struck Larak Island, the first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29. As of Sept 11, the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause fired — CENTCOM struck Larak Island, the first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29.

combat death, a widening to a further new state with confirmed attribution) are not. As of Sept 1-2, the strikes clause was already firing again at vastly greater scale — CENTCOM confirms nearly 100 targets confirmed US casualty found as of this run); the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause did NOT fire despite Iran's Sept 2 retaliation hitting four countries simultaneously (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — every one close. The evidence is nonetheless the largest single-cycle escalation since the flip line itself fired, which is why P moved sharply down that cycle. UPDATE, Sept 6: CENTCOM has now confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike of the three unfired clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100) — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved >2 points) and, unlike the Sept 2 cycle, without a new shipping attack, fatality, or seizure. Oman's own government confirmed a temporary corridor Aug 25, but the confirmed direct US-Iran naval exchange makes a durable, US-accepted deal considered confirmed US combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 — any of which would independently fire a fresh flip-line clause and likely warrant a larger cut. UPDATE, Sept 7: CENTCOM confirmed a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) in retaliation for a second IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship - signal, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets, but explicitly not yet executed (no boundaries announced, no confirmed incident tied to it). This does not independently re-fire any of the three unfired clauses (no authority. UPDATE, Sept 9: CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) in retaliation for a second IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship - to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but an intraday cross is explicitly not a sustained close, so that clause does not fire either. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (war), whether the restricted zone is actually declared and enforced, whether the Iran-Oman corridor deal is actually signed, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state. UPDATE, Sept 10: CENTCOM confirmed a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) in retaliation for a second IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship - port of Mocha, closing in on Bab el-Mandeb — a second chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already priced, and no strait closure has actually been confirmed, so this doesn't fire a clause either. Brent now trades at \$100. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. UPDATE, Sept 12: the Houthis have held a fifth straight session near/above \$104. Still, no strait CLOSURE or shipping interdiction has actually been executed by the Houthis, so the widening clause does not fire (same actor/theater), and no US casualty occurred. AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. Watch next cycle for: whether the Houthis actually close or interdict shipping through Bab al-Mandeb (vs. merely holding its shores/islands), whether Zuqar Island (Petrolina), hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement Sept 11) — does not independently fire either the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater, active since the Sept 1 Erbil strike) or the new state clause. WEEKLY refresh, is LEFT AS DRAFT for Alex's manual review regardless of the move's size — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority. Watch next cycle for: whether resp new state. UPDATE, Sept 19 (full weekly refresh): none of the four clauses newly fires this cycle. Iran's parliament still has not enacted NPT withdrawal (proposal-stage only); Trump's Sept 17 "big decision" remains unannounced renewal is institutional gridlock, not a new sanction or act of war; the "Trend" tanker strike (Sept 17-18) is newly confirmed but is a continuation of the already-priced tanker campaign, not a widening or a fresh case of escalation. Watch next cycle for: the outcome of the Sept 22 UN General Assembly Gulf-states meeting, whether the NPT-withdrawal bill is actually voted on, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state.

## My Decision

**UPDATED DRAFT — SEPTEMBER 26, 2026 (2026-09-26\_draft3) · FULL WEEKLY REFRESH · AWAITING MY STAMP · THIS PILLAR RE-RATED (WINDOW SPLIT)**

**P (2026-09-26\_draft3, FULL WEEKLY refresh, DRAFT — awaiting Alex's stamp; RE-RATED, window split): 1 / 2 / 15 / 34 / 66 · Prior committed Impact: 8 (uniform) · This pillar's signals: 1mo -4.70 · 3mo -4.99 · 6mo -3.92 (Strong Bear) · 1yr -1.66 (Bear) · 3yr +1.41 (Mild Bull) · Master (Neutral) / +0.47 horizon-weighted (Neutral), versus +0.02 / +0.55 on the Sept 23 committed baseline · Leave-one-out range: -0.76 to +0.59**

**Sept 26 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-26\_draft3), this version — RE-RATED DOWN, 3/3/16/35/66 — 1/2/15/34/66, and this REVERSES an earlier draft of this same cycle.** That reversal and put a concrete seven-day plan on the record, conveyed via Qatar — the US lifts the naval blockade, waives oil sanctions and releases an estimated \$12bn in frozen assets over roughly four to five days, had been refusing to score, and it drove a proposed UP move (a window split to 2/5/18/36/66) on the reasoning that the Nov 3 midterms fall outside the 1-month window and inside the 3- and 6-month of sufficiency rule it could not move a score, and this report correctly declined to use it. **That analysis went stale on Saturday.** On Sept 26 Trump rejected the plan *himself, on the record*, to reporters outside history." Captured independently by CNN, Fox News Digital and Al Jazeera as coverage of public remarks. That is a **primary source from the only person with authority to accept the plan**, and it must not that floor was set, and both are on the record. First, Trump paired the rejection with "I like making a deal too," and has not withdrawn his own Sept 22 UN General Assembly prediction of a deal "right after inspectors — "That is absolutely correct" — in a CBS excerpt released Sept 25 ahead of the Sunday Sept 27 broadcast; conditional on US acceptance, but the first movement on the nuclear file in weeks. So **discipline bites hardest:** the WSJ's *other* claims — that Trump privately told aides he expects bombing to resume after the midterms, and that the US has told mediators he will not lift the blockade — remain confirmed on record they have "no intention of dismantling" the blockade, was **checked and could not be found at all**; that exact phrasing traces to an April 2026 newsletter posing it as a hypothesis, and said Sept 26 it "would be incorrect to describe recent talks as a major breakthrough," which presumes talks exist; and Iran is formally still awaiting a US response. **Stamp decision: LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED.**

**Sept 24 draft (score set 2026-09-24\_draft) — WRITTEN BUT NEVER DELIVERED; SUPERSEDED above.** It proposed 3/3/16/35/66 → 2/4/17/35/66 and its report edits claimed "COMMITTED · AUTO-STAMPED" and **HELD UP, but its statement that "no new tanker incidents dated Sept 23-24 were found" was FALSIFIED** — a cargo vessel was struck in Hormuz on Sept 23 with two casualties. Its original text follows, **2026** — which yesterday's cycle did not price: the 2026-09-23 note scored the Witkoff/Kushner-Araghchi meeting held that same day but never mentioned the speech. That omission is logged here rather than with Iran that lets them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before ... or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic, and do it quickly?" — and then predicted the timing: "I believe we'll make a deal the election" falls *outside* the 1mo window (to ~Oct 24) and *inside* the 3mo (to ~Dec 24) and 6mo windows. The one person with the authority to sign a deal has, on the record, put one past the near window "annihilate" threat. **Further counterweight, holding the move to one point:** President Pezeshkian's defiant Sept 23 UNGA address (Washington Post, CNBC, ms.now — 3+ independent), lashing out at Trump separately ruled out lifting the naval blockade before Iran shows sufficient goodwill. 12mo and 36mo **held** — a campaign-timing prediction says nothing about the multi-year strategic read. **Reported but not scored** roughly 15-20 days, and an end to the US blockade, via Qatari, Pakistani and Egyptian mediators. Gulf News and Aaj English TV carry it — but their own headlines label it "report," because they are syndicated exactly this treatment. It would argue for a *larger* up-move than the one taken here, and is deliberately not used. (b) The Pentagon added a **19th US death** to its Iran-war database Sept 22 (Washington Post) which requires a confirmed new US *combat* death — logged so the casualty total stays accurate, not scored. No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran and no new tanker incidents dated Sept 23-24 were found.

**Sept 23 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-23\_draft), this version — the first upward re-rate on this pillar since Sept 13:** two dated, well-corroborated diplomatic developments Sept 22, 2026 clear the ports — Tehran's proposal was reportedly delivered to the US via mediators on Sept 16. Corroborated independently by 8+ outlets carrying the Reuters wire (Washington Times, Yahoo, US News, The Star, The Times of Israel, New Arab, Al Arabiya) plus independent confirmation from Iranian state media of the Araghchi-Witkoff meeting itself — not a single-source claim. **Sized like the Sept 13 precedent** (a combat war on every "resistance front" Tehran names — a wide gap from a signed deal; President Pezeshkian is in New York but will explicitly NOT meet Trump directly, so this remains a working-level channel; Sept 22 (one aggregator only) that Iran's Parliament Speaker Ghalibaf said Iran will not return to talks until US demands are met is flagged, not used, per the sufficiency rule — as is a SINGLE-SOURCE Sept 23 report of direct strikes on a genuinely new state, sustained Brent close above \$100) is independently fired or un-fired either way. Context, not scored: Brent crude fell to ~\$99/bbl by Sept 22, a 5th straight down since the outage, full throughput recovery estimated 6-8 weeks (Reuters via multiple outlets) — both directionally consistent with, but not independently used to justify, this re-rate. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly: 1mo -4.70, 3mo -4.99, 6mo -3.92, 1yr -1.66, 3yr +1.41, Master (Neutral) / +0.47 horizon-weighted (Neutral).** WebSearch clean throughout. This is an ordinary light daily touch, no window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call bar is **"Alex (auto-stamped)." CLARITY Act, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro all held flat on independent re-check this cycle — see those reports.**

**Sept 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-19\_draft), prior version:** a full independent primary-source research pass across all five windows, against the last committed baseline (2026-09-18\_draft3) and a lawmaker statement (Sept 7-13) urged the legal Article X process, Parliament Presidium spokesman Abbas Goudarzi said withdrawal "can easily" be done, and a bill was submitted for expedited consideration. Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Oman, Bahrain, Kuwait) on a future decision; near-term windows already at this pillar's practical floor. **The Sept 22 meeting is flagged as this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.** The UN Security Council failed 11-5-0 on a Security Council Report — institutional gridlock over the 2025 snapback dispute, not a new sanction or act of war. The Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike (Sept 17-18), which last cycle's targeted search comms reversed last cycle's NOT FIRED call, but it is a continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign, not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P. Brent settled ~\$103.21/bbl (Sept 18, FTSE tracker) — a mild, fragile de-escalatory data point — while a Houthi-linked air-raid alert hit Riyadh Sept 19 for the first time since July (Times of Israel liveblog) — a mixed signal; neither clears the bar. FM Arafat's Islamabad MOU (Mehr News, corroborated by Samaa) — a net wash. **P HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** Research capability was NOT degraded this cycle — full WebSearch access, 10+ independent outlets per window, no limitation, not a capability gap. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh — categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED.**

**Sept 18 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-18\_draft), prior cycle:** two dated items were found and weighed. Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime (Sept 17-18, Axios) — 5+ independent), but it is rhetoric about an undated future decision, and the near-term windows (1mo/3mo P=1) already price maximal active-war uncertainty, so it does not clear the bar for a full re-rate. **P HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** Research capability was NOT degraded this cycle — full WebSearch access, 10+ independent outlets per window, no limitation, not a capability gap. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh — categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED.** authority. Tokenization RWA is the only pillar that moved this cycle — see that report.

*Prior cycle (Sept 17 light daily touch):* re-checked — no new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced. **P HELD FLAT. AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 17, 2026.**

**Sept 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-15\_draft), this version — yesterday's up-move is retraced, because the meeting it rested on was called off:** the Salalah ministerial never convened. CNN, Fox News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail. Bahrain had ruled out attending, no GCC state had confirmed, and the UAE had downgraded its representation; Iran's MFA blames a Saudi request for a meeting (+2.8%) on the news — a market price, reported not scored. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat). This is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was clear, and Oman naming a firm new date with Saudi and Bahraini attendance confirmed would re-fire the de-escalation read faster than it retraced.

**Sept 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-13\_draft), prior cycle — the first UPWARD re-rate on this pillar since August 6, now superseded by the postponement above:** ONE sufficiency-clearing event **convene in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss navigation through the Strait of Hormuz** — specifically safe and temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance, and short-term maritime security. PRIMARY: the Iranian MFA's own statement, describing the gathering as an effort "to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security." **Four counterweights, all new and dated, are logged and sized in — they are why this is +2 points and not a reversal:** (1) Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will NOT attend, so GCC participation is incomplete; (2) a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting vessels, which arguably institutionalises rather than lifts the blockade; (4) the kinetic war did not pause — on Sept 13 a combat vessel was established), a Houthi projectile struck Jazan in Saudi Arabia causing injuries and damaging a mosque, and Houthi forces continued trading strikes with Yemen's internationally recognised government over the Red Sea; (3) a downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired — attributed by wire coverage to this diplomacy plus the already-logged IEA demand forecast. **No flip-line clause fires in either direction** — the outcome is unambiguous and has NOT been met: it requires a signed, US-accepted Hormuz reopening that holds a full clean week. An announced meeting at which no deal is expected is not that. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly: 1mo -4.70, 3mo -4.99, 6mo -3.92, 1yr -1.66, 3yr +1.41, Master (Neutral) / +0.47 horizon-weighted (Neutral).** near windows where the meeting actually sits, and is sized symmetrically against the 1-to-2-point daily cuts this pillar has been taking all month. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was clear, and Oman naming a firm new date with Saudi and Bahraini attendance confirmed would re-fire the de-escalation read faster than it retraced. **this set is AUTO-STAMPED:** the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority — widened Sept 2 so that move size, call-band movement, and how novel the news feels are no longer grounds to withhold — **this set is AUTO-STAMPED:**

**Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12\_draft2), prior version — still DRAFT, awaiting Alex's manual review:** four parallel adversarial research passes ran across all four qualitative pillars. The War Risk found ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond the morning baseline: **Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — was hit by drones launched from Yemen.** Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets, including the operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility, and the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a specific group. **Does NOT fire** (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — this is escalation within an existing theater, not a new one); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER:** Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight). The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure was independently re-verified as still holding (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER:** the runbook, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size or how the sufficiency rule was applied. **This set is LEFT AS DRAFT: status draft, NOT AUTO-STAMPED.**

**Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12\_draft), prior cycle:** the load-bearing development is that Houthi forces, an Iran-aligned proxy, have moved from "closing in on" to actual island-level operations (Sept 11, giving them Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island in the strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — confirmed by 6+ independent outlets). This is a genuine US-restraint counterweight, logged honestly. Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms two more vessels struck near Khasab, Oman Sept 10 (one afire); an IRGC claim of a Salldrone strike (Sept 10, Yemen is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a new flip-line event, but is a bigger step than the routine daily grind.

(WebSearch working throughout), and verification passed clean — under the runbook's widened delegated authority, neither the size of a move nor the severity of the underlying news is by itself a reason to report.

**Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11\_draft), prior cycle:** the load-bearing development is that this pillar's own **"sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause has FIRED**. Brent end (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give now is that it fired. *Correction to the prior cycle:* the Sept 10 run logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close. Second, fuller reporting landed on the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire; no further new state was struck, so the widening clause does not fire either. Logged but not used to 2.5 mb/d demand-contraction forecast. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/4/20/40/71** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5→4, 6mo 22→20, 12mo 42→40, 36mo 72→71. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinal move nor the drama of a flip-line clause firing is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** CLARITY Act and Tokeniza

**Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10\_draft), prior cycle:** two new dated facts since the Sept 9 baseline. (1) CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by Day 194, corroborating Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck previously Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does NOT fire; CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm figure was checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own no-casualties statement). (2) Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail, clearing the sufficiency bar. This is the same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already priced (not a strike on a further new state), and no strait closure or shipping interdiction h Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — m watching next cycle, but does not independently fire that clause. Net: a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yemen/Red Sea territorial escalation, both intensifying the trend already pr strike and a same-theater territorial shift do not move the multi-year thesis). No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER **"Alex (auto-stamped)."**

**Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09\_draft), prior cycle:** CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil) confirms U with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days. Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own release — clear Island are both existing theater, so the widening-to-a-new-state clause does not fire either; this is a repeat pattern, not a fresh category of event. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday today (S point and the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause either. Iran's Se time. This is a continuation and intensification of the same escalation trend the Sept 6/8 cycles already priced, not a fresh flip-line event. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo flip (Neutral → Neutral)** — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

**Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08\_draft), prior cycle:** Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record (Iranian state TV, carried by Press TV and Tehran Times), Sept 6-7, that I an Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be signed "in the coming days." Corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced," and no zone had actually been declared as of this cycle's research cutoff. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS US KIA redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced trend, not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed. **P RE bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral)** — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed,**

**Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06\_draft), prior cycle:** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had explicitly withheld f Stark 1 (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guid this clears the sufficiency bar the Sept 5 baseline explicitly withheld on, and reveals a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels rather than a quiet single-tanker interdiction. Separately, Sep confirmed, and are NOT used to move P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS still shows 18 confirmed US deaths (unchanged since Sept 4), Kharg Island/Jask/Gul **9→8, 6mo 27→25, 12mo 47→45, 36mo 74→73**. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar (CENTCOM's own release), and the master FINAL NUMBER stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

**Sept 3-5 re-check, held flat:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night \$100. Two developments logged, NOT used to move P: (1) Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts who concluded the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding-party strike was likely a direct has still not accepted responsibility (VP Vance: "extremely skeptical," Sept 4, calling it under investigation), and the confirmation resolves attribution of an ALREADY-PRICED Sept 1-2 event rather than descr oil-export terminal — no CENTCOM or independent Western multi-source confirmation as of this research pass, so per the sufficiency rule this single-narrative claim is NOT used to move P. WATCH NEXT C warned the US that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale attack" on Israel; the IDF took the ridge Sept 3, but no such attack has been confirmed as of this run — a live advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here and not corrected retroactively.

**Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05\_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch. The Sept 5 tanker report has firmed up considerably since the daily touch a few hours earlier: the Persian broadcaster editorially independent of and adversarial to Tehran — obtained video of three US radio warnings ordering the crew to abandon ship before the strike, corroborating that a strike and w issued any statement confirming or denying this specific strike as of this research pass (distinct from CENTCOM's on-the-record July 14-15 naval-blockade doctrine, under which the Curacao-flagged M/T B (CENTCOM/Pentagon on the record) or independent-of-the-accusing-party corroboration of that specific fact; Iran International's video corroborates that warnings were issued and a strike occurred, but do CENTCOM confirmation or denial. None of the pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week regardless: no confirmed new US combat death (standing count remains 18 per GlobalSecurity Day 189) sustained-flip threshold. **P HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of move size (here, zero) — left for**

This is a light daily catch-up against the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped) — but it turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since the flip line itself fired Aug 30. **The load-bearing new fact** war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike on Kuhestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party (Hormozgan governor's office move P. It is reported as context for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — all repeat targ

**P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74.** Every window moved under 8 points, but this is the largest front-loaded cut since the Aug 30-31 flip-line direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause is escalating sharply in scale, which is what's driving the size of this move.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the four-country retaliation hit repeat targets, most projectiles were intercepted, and no US casualty is confirmed. But the trajectory since Aug 30 is n genuinely new state, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 would each independently warrant a further, larger cut.

**Why this was originally left as a draft Sept 2, pending manual review:** (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of that day's four-country retaliation — is single-narrative: cut resting partly on it; (2) the jump in scale — nearly 100 targets and the war's first-ever direct tanker strikes, versus two rocket/mine-launchers on Aug 30 — was a genuinely novel escalation this pillar's p source), raising the cost of a miscalibrated cut. It also independently flipped the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set — under the rules in force

**September 3, 2026 update:** Alex reviewed this cycle's research (delivered as PDFs Sept 2) and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy in CLAUDE.md: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no the single-narrative wedding-casualty claim was correctly kept out of the P move under the sufficiency rule. Nothing about the underlying facts, sourcing, or the sizing of the cut changed — only the stamp

*Historical note: the paragraph above was the Sept 2 cycle's original manual-review flag, superseded by the Sept 3 auto-stamp policy widening and, again, by this cycle's own auto-stamp. Left here for the audit t*

## What Changed Since Last Check

FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 26, 2026 (score set 2026-09-26\_draft3, DRAFT — NOT STAMPED) — checked against the last COMMITTED baseline, 2026-09-23\_draft (3/3/16/35/66). One primary-source research pass, a dedica which is why this one is keyed \_draft3 — see the divergence note in My Decision.

- ★ ★ **THIS CYCLE REVERSED ITS OWN CALL, and the reversal is logged in full rather than presented as the original conclusion.** An earlier draft of this same Sept 26 cycle scored Iran UP a Both the original reasoning and the reason it failed are kept below, because a reader should be able to see the judgement change and audit it.
- ★ ★ **THE DECIDING FACT — PRIMARY, Sept 26:** speaking to reporters outside the White House, Trump said **"I reject their proposal," "I've rejected their deal,"** and "that deal would not be a coverage of public remarks. **The only person with authority to accept the plan rejected it on the record,** so under the sufficiency rule this both may and must move P.
- ★ ★ **THE CATALYST THAT IS NOW DEAD — Araghchi's seven-day plan, Sept 25.** Outside the UN Security Council, conveyed via Qatar: ~4-5 days of US steps (lift the blockade, waive oil sanc independent originals; Araghchi added the US steps "are all already in the MOU." Real, well-sourced, and *refused* — which is why it ends up reversing the Sept 23 bump rather than extending
- **Why NOT a full reversal to the old 1/1/14/33/66 floor.** Two things are genuinely new since that floor, both on the record. (1) Trump paired the rejection with "I like making a deal too" and and 6mo windows. (2) Pezeshkian offered on the record to readmit UN nuclear inspectors ("That is absolutely correct"), in a CBS excerpt released Sept 25 ahead of the Sunday Sept 27 broadc and 36mo holds at 66.

- **STILL NOT SCORED, and this is where the rule bites hardest — the excluded claims are the *most bearish* ones.** The WSJ's other assertions — that Trump privately told aides he expects b excluded. A claim circulating this cycle that *senior White House officials confirmed on record* they have "no intention of dismantling" the blockade was checked and **could not be found at all**; seven-day plan — the two are not merged.
- **LIVE CONTRARY EVIDENCE, weighed not buried:** Reuters (Sept 25–26, unnamed US official) has the US in "positive, constructive discussions with Iran through mediators" on the nuclear file the honest reason this pillar does not fall below its prior floor.
- ★ ★ **FALSIFIED — a cargo vessel WAS struck in Hormuz on Sept 23**, caught fire, lost control and drifted; crew evacuated; **two casualties**. **UKMTO did not specify killed or injured, so this** Merchant crew, not US service members, so the combat-death clause is untouched. ukmt.org 403'd, so this is wire-derived rather than primary-verified.
- **CORRECTION to the Sept 23 committed set:** it called the Sept 22 contact the "first direct-channel" US–Iran contact. Witkoff's own account says the talks ran "through the mediators, who sh
- **Escalation on the other side of the ledger:** two Houthi salvos at Saudi Arabia (six ballistic missiles toward Taif and Yanbu on Sept 24; two missiles and two drones toward Khamis Mushait and conditions are met."
- ★ **A NEW STATE OF AFFAIRS this report had not recorded: no announced US strike on Iranian territory since Sept 1**, about 3.5 weeks — so the strikes clause that fired Aug 30 is now d
- **Corrected market and shipping figures, all labelled as market prices or tracker data.** Brent: \$106.60 close Sept 24 (+3.4%, intraday high \$108.23), \$104.37 Sept 25 (–2.09%) — superseding 13/day, which understated it, and is corrected. An IMF PortWatch reading of 1 (Sept 20) uses PortWatch's own 85/day baseline and is **not mixed** with the Reuters series.
- **Casualty-record corrections:** DCAS holds at **19** (11 hostile, 8 non-hostile). The 19th was **Capt.** Bianca C. Wilkerson, **posthumously promoted to major**, who died **Sept 18** of a cause **DCAS I** and unread, and material enough to need its own pass.
- **NOT SCORED, and it cuts against this cycle's own conclusion:** the WSJ reported Sept 25–26, citing unnamed US officials, that Trump **rejected** the seven-day plan and expects to resume bo the same treatment this pillar gives anonymous claims in the other direction. Also not scored: The National's 60-day road map (still single-original-source, and a different frame that is not me
- **Score decision: RE-RATED, window split, to 1/2/15/34/66** (–1/+2/+2/+1/0). **LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED** — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated aut
- **What would change my mind:** a *named* US official accepting or formally rejecting the seven-day plan would resolve the biggest ambiguity here in either direction; then a confirmed new US

Carried forward — what changed in the September 23 light daily touch (2026-09-23\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a senior Iranian official told Reuters (Sept 22) Iran can reopen the Strait of Hormuz within 7 days if the US eases military pressure and lifts its naval blockade** — Tehran's
- ★ ★ **NEW — US and Iranian officials (Witkoff/Kushner for the US, FM Araghchi for Iran) held a three-hour mediated meeting at the UN General Assembly sidelines in New York, Sept** meeting is scheduled "in the very near future." Corroborated across 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, Axios, The Hill, Times of Israel, New Arab, Al Arabiya) plus independent Iranian state-m
- **Counterweights, logged and sized in:** Iran's conditions remain steep and unmet (full blockade lift, release of ALL frozen assets, end to war on every named "resistance front"); Pezeshkian wi Speaker Ghalibaf rejected talks, and a single-source, unverified report of new US sanctions on Iran airline providers, are both flagged and NOT used.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED UP, modestly: 1mo 1→3, 3mo 1→3, 6mo 14→16, 12mo 33→35, 36mo held at 66.** No window moved more than 2 points; sourcing clears the primary-source-pl

Carried forward — what changed in the September 22 light daily touch (2026-09-22\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- Not independently re-researched that cycle — a targeted single-pillar Fed & Macro follow-up (two regional Fed survey findings; see that pillar's report), not a fresh Iran War Risk research pass
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** Not re-researched that cycle (targeted single-pillar touch) — carried forward from the Sept 19 weekly review. AUTO-STAMPED alongside Fed &

Carried forward — the September 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh, for continuity:

FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 19, 2026 (score set **2026-09-19\_draft**, DRAFT — awaiting Alex's manual review) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-18\_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66), via a full independent prim

- **Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal.** A further 130-lawmaker statement (Sept 7-13) urged parliament to begin the legal Article X withdraw Iran's own Foreign Ministry still calls it "still being prepared" (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarnyi, IFP News — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliat
- **Trump told Axios (Sept 17) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime**, ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf-sta independent). Still rhetoric about an undated future decision, not an action — but **the Sept 22 meeting itself is now flagged as this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle**
- **The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its panel of independent experts monitoring reimposed Iran sanctions**, Russia and China vetoing (Somalia/Pakistan abstain Russia/China-vs-E3 legal dispute over the 2025 "snapback" sanctions reimposition — institutional/procedural gridlock, ambiguous direction, not a new sanction or act of war. Does not move
- **CORROBORATION UPDATE, reverses last cycle's "not fired/not used" call, but is NOT used to move P:** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18 is no safe, no confirmed spill; no CENTCOM confirmation or denial was found. This is a continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign (the US struck three Iranian tankers Sept 1-5), not a
- **MARKET PRICE, reported not scored:** Brent ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18 (down 1.5% day-over-day but still near multi-month highs, having spiked toward \$109 in early September on tanker/energ
- **Mixed proxy-front signal, neither clears the bar:** as of Sept 19, Iran has gone a ninth straight day without striking a "host state" (GlobalSecurity.org's OSINT day-by-day tracker) — a mild, f
- **Diplomatic wash, not used:** Iranian FM Araghchi said Iran and Oman "agreed a plan" to reopen the Strait (TASS, Caspianpost) but separately clarified (Mehr News, corroborated by Samaa) th
- **Research capability:** full WebSearch available, no degradation. WebFetch to arbitrary domains was blocked in this sandbox (relied on WebSearch summaries, not direct fetches of full UN pres
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded fro

Carried forward — what changed in the September 18 light daily touch (2026-09-18\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 18, 2026 (score set **2026-09-18\_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-17\_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66). **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- **Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime**, ahead of a Tuesday UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Axios o windows already price maximal active-war uncertainty (1mo/3mo P=1), so it does not clear the bar for a further move.
- **Checked and NOT USED — a claim that the IRGC struck a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz Sept 18.** An initial general search surfaced the claim; a follow-up single claims — no P move on it either way.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 17 light daily touch (2026-09-17\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 17, 2026 (score set **2026-09-17\_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-16\_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66). **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- **Re-checked for a new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT-withdrawal statement — found none.** Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons sta Saudi pipeline repair timeline, or Hormuz shipping.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 16 light daily touch (2026-09-16\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 16, 2026 (score set **2026-09-16\_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-15\_draft committed baseline (1/1/18/38/70). **This pillar RE-RATED DOWN on the 6/12**

- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council** — a primary institutional escalation not previously priced by this pillar.
- ★ ★ **NEW — 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for NPT withdrawal**, with a hardline MP saying an emergency
- **Counterweight, logged:** President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons; the Foreign Ministry says the withdrawal bill "is still being prepared" — a real step, not
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, 1/1/18/38/70 → 1/1/14/33/66.** 1mo/3mo held at the floor (no room to move further); 6mo 18→14, 12mo 38→33, 36mo 70→66.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 15 light daily touch (2026-09-15\_draft, committed, auto-stamped, held flat), for continuity:

- ★ **The Salalah ministerial remains postponed with no new date** — the fact that drove yesterday's re-rate down, unchanged. Al Jazeera (Sept 14) adds detail already consistent with what was interests of consensus."
- ★ **Saudi Arabia's East-West (Petroline) pipeline is still offline** — already priced Sept 12. Saudi energy-ministry sources put the loss at roughly **700,000 barrels a day**; Aramco has not said how much.
- ★ **INTERESTED-PARTY CLAIM, reported not scored**: Bloomberg (Sept 14) reports an *Iranian claim* that a tanker struck mines in the Strait of Hormuz. Uncorroborated by any independent party.
- ★ **MARKET PRICES, reported not scored**: Brent closed above **\$105** and WTI rose toward **\$102** (Sept 14–15), slightly below yesterday's ~\$108 Brent print. Still inside the already-fired "sustained."
- ★ **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/18/38/70**. No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 14 light daily touch (2026-09-14\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 14, 2026 (score set **2026-09-14\_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-13\_draft committed baseline (3/3/19/39/70).

- ★ **★ NEW — the Salalah ministerial did not happen. Oman postponed it on Sunday, September 13, with no new date.** PRIMARY: Oman News Agency — "It has been decided to postpone the ministerial meeting." Secondary: Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail (Sept 13-14). This is the exact fact yesterday's upward re-rate was built on, and it did not survive the weekend.
- ★ **The problem is Gulf-Arab buy-in, not the calendar. Bahrain explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed participation** before the postponement; and the **UAE had already agreed** to attend.
- ★ **Iran says Saudi Arabia asked for the delay, citing the Yemen war, and calls that a pretext — SINGLE-PARTY SOURCED and NOT used to move P.** This is Iran's MFA spokesman characterizing the delay. "Iran's cooperation contributes to stability and lasting cooperation in our region."
- ★ **FM Araqchi capped the value of what survives: the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz"** (Tehran Times / Mehr News, Sept 13 — Iranian state media). A joint navigational charts drawn, draft joint statement prepared. That framework survives the postponement — which is why the 1-year window held one point above the Sept 12 level rather than full.
- ★ **Market reaction — a MARKET PRICE, reported and not scored**: Brent crude pushed past **\$107/bbl (+2.8%, \$107.54 November delivery)** and WTI to **\$102.34 (+2.3%)** on the postponement.
- ★ **Checked and REJECTED as stale**: research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Oman's Salalah and Duqm ports, which would have been materially escalatory. Those incidents are dated **March 2026**.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from 3/3/19/39/70) — 1mo -2 (the one near-term de-escalation catalyst evaporated with no replacement date) · 3mo -2 (the GCC re-rate structural moved). Ordinary light daily touch, full research access, verification clean — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated authority.

Carried forward — the September 13 light daily touch, for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 13, 2026 (score set 2026-09-13\_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12\_draft2 full weekly refresh (still draft, awaiting Alex's manual review).

- ★ **★ NEW — and for the first time since August 6, it cuts the other way: Iran's foreign ministry announced Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iran's neighbors** met at the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. This is the first time high-level Iranian and GCC officials have gathered in one place since the war began in February. PRIMARY: Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS.
- ★ **Counterweight 1 — incomplete participation**: Bahrain announced Sept 12 that it will not attend the Oman meeting.
- ★ **Counterweight 2 — no outcome expected**: an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that no signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting. This is a convening, not a settlement.
- ★ **Counterweight 3 — what is actually being negotiated**: the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting vessels.
- ★ **Counterweight 4 — the fighting did not pause**. Sept 13: a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the attack on "international terrorism"). The internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13).
- ★ **Market corroboration, reported NOT scored**: Brent gave back 4.24% Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 clause fired — attributed to the postponement.
- ★ **No flip-line clause fires in either direction**. The two fired downside clauses (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) both remain fired and confirmed.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo/3mo/6mo/12mo +2 each, 36mo held flat at 70. Concentrated on the near windows where the meeting was confirmed. Full research touch with full research capability, clean verification, and sourcing well above the sufficiency bar. The direction of the move is not itself a reason to withhold the stamp.

Previous entry — FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12\_draft2, still draft) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12\_draft committed baseline.

- ★ **★ NEW — a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike this week: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass export route, hit by drone strikes** (OilPrice.com); Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamchah border crossing.
- ★ **Attribution caveat**: no group has claimed responsibility; Trump's Dublin remark that Iran is "probably" responsible is a single, hedged, unconfirmed statement, not treated as fact.
- ★ **Neither flip-line clause fires**: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (none confirmed).
- ★ **Logged, not scored**: the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) urging "maximum restraint," and Trump's account of a private Houthis restraint signal on Yemen — both counterweighting the escalation.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh** (size).

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12\_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — a second global oil chokepoint moves from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control.** Houthis forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, captured Dhubab and Murad Bay in the Bab al-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Materially more severe than the Sept 10 baselinable.
- ★ **Logged, honest counterweight**: Saudi Crown Prince MBS twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting support offered instead).
- ★ **★ NEW — UKMTO Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire** (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborated).
- ★ **Logged, not scored (single-source)**: IRGC's own claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. Neither the widening clause nor the escalation scale of the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10\_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — Houthis forces launched a significant ballistic-missile-and-drone attack directly on Saudi Arabian soil Sept 8, hitting Saudi Aramco energy facilities — including the 400,000-barrel-a-day** (confirmed 73 wounded (NPR, NBC News, Bloomberg, The Times of Israel, US News, Al Jazeera, The Daily Caller, SRN News, plus the Saudi Energy Ministry's own statement)). Saudi Arabia is a rare case of a rare event.
- ★ **★ NEW — Brent crude closes above \$100/bbl for a THIRD consecutive session, moving decisively to \$105.71-\$108** — the highest since May 19 (Reuters-linked wires, Bloomberg, Energy Intelligence not formally called fired).
- ★ **★ NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors votes 23-3-8 Sept 9 to refer Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear non-proliferation breaches** — the first such referral in two decades (move P).
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, larger than the recent 1-point touches, to 1/3/19/38/69** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -3, 12mo -4, 36mo -3. Band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10\_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan's armed forces does not fire; no casualties on either side — the US-casualty clause does not fire either.
- ★ **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait,** a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line).
- **Brent crude traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, but still short of a sustained cross.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independent. **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority. Neutral)

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09\_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharbela)** (GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship"). Both Iranian missile attempts evaded, no US personnel killed.
- **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24,** trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC, ABC News) — the closest that cycle had.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08\_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning** (Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer says boundaries have yet to be announced; no zone has actually been declared. A parallel claim of an imminent strike.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independent. **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority: status committed, stamped\_by "Alex (auto-stamped)".

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06\_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld: THREE Iranian tankers struck (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) in retaliation for an IRGC** (Reuters).
- **Sept 6's single-source IRGC claims of further strikes on 3 more tankers, 3 "US-linked" vessels, and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remained US-unconfirmed — not used.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** (from 1/9/27/47/74) — no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05\_draft2, committed by Alex), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Kuwait and UAE, both REPEAT targets.** A US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit; the widening-to-a-new-state clause.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Sept 5: the Iranian-flagged NITC tanker STARK 1 reportedly hit by four missiles ~6nm off Kharg Island.** Iran's Tasnim (state media) makes the claim; Iran International (independent) says CENTCOM has not confirmed or denied it. NOT used to move P per the sufficiency rule — WATCH NEXT CYCLE.
- **Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts corroborating the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding-strike casualty claim as likely a direct US-munition hit** — resolved.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74.** No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100).
- **Correction:** the same-day earlier 2026-09-05\_draft's commit message claimed it was auto-stamped, but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced — a bug in that session.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02\_draft, committed), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, ~50x the scale of the Aug 30 strike.** IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms),** under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy.
- ★ ★ **NEW, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan.** Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. bride).
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait.** All four are repeat targets — does NOT independently fire the thesis.
- **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tue Sept 1 (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6; WTI ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100 flip line. Both sides now on-record threatening larger future action (Trump).
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 (Sept 2)** — down from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75) — 1mo -6, 3mo -6, 6mo -5, 12mo -3, 36mo -1; front-loaded, kept under the 8-point threshold, but this week's action threatening larger future action, and the master call band flip Mild Bull → Neutral); **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamped.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01\_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING a cross-border drone incursion.** (Reuters, Maritime, and Iran International).
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran,** calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo) — not a de-escalation signal.
- **Brent continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday, multiple market-desk reports)** — second straight cycle of gains on this news thread; Jordan struck again Aug 30-31 but remained a repeat target.
- **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 (Sept 1)** — down from \$78,447.16 (Aug 31, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — 1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat; no single new fact independently fired a fresh flip-line touch, no window moved >2 points, master call band unchanged vs. the last stamped set (Mild Bull → Mild Bull), sourcing well above the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31\_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson (Capt. Tim Hawkins) plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two Iranian ships on the pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement.** King Hussein and Al-Azraq airbases targeted; no casualties.
- **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 (Aug 31)** — up from \$77,666.16 (Aug 29, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, front-loaded, to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76) — 1mo -5, 3mo -5, 6mo -4, 12mo -3, 36mo -1, sized to a single resumed-strike-night shock. AUTO-STAMPED.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29\_draft, held P flat, left as draft, now superseded), for continuity:

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov (sb0613, sb0614) and an OFAC recent-actions entry.** ~60 entities/independent. CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts. **For the first time, digital assets was named a sanctionable sector — 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed.** Real, primary-confirmed, crypto-specific.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: every prior corridor permanent. Still "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance. No fee terms disclosed.
- **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents,** Aug 24 (off Oman, engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, crew safe).
- **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28:** Iranian sea mines cleared from the shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began.

- **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead** across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the prior 15-19 range.
- **NEW — Trump announced Aug 25 the Strait had been demined**, with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27
- **NEW — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week** for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News/Lloyd's List) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week
- **NEW, FLAGGED AND NOT USED — an IRGC spokesman's Aug 26 claim of an Iran-Oman Hormuz revenue-sharing agreement** (Sepah News, Iranian state military source) is unconfirmed and requires.
- **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21) — moving further from the \$100 flip line.
- **No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29;** no new US/CENTCOM strikes found (GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker, 28th consecutive clean night).
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 (Aug 29)** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 (Aug 22, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76** — the confirmed sanctions escalation and the confirmed Oman corridor upgrade roughly offset; neither independently clears the sufficiency

Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28\_draft), for audit continuity: that draft first logged the two Aug 24/27 tanker incidents, Trump's Aug 25 demining claim, and the IRGC revenue-sharing claim on the Aug 17-21 gap.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22\_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23), for continuity: Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never delivered; all four as not-delivered and independently re-verified via four parallel primary-source research passes, cutting P to 14/22/38/54/76 and delivering it as a draft. The Aug 22 full weekly refresh independently re-researched the

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel escalation")
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — tre
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign**, Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) claimed
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22**, the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re-check
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel escalation" was
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (100+ most Hormuz-specific trackers). This softens the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" framing, which was more precise than the sources support; corrected everywhere in this report.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing the incident on the baseline.
- **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs. 60 prior)
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran said it would not
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claim), not a
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft; H
- **Decision for the full reasoning.**

## Sources

Retrieved & graded September 19, 2026, FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-19\_draft; earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then secondary sources, then analysis. Sanctions-panel vote, the "Trend" tanker corroboration, oil prices, and the Iran-Oman Strait diplomatic track; no primary-source access degradation, though WebFetch to arbitrary domains was blocked in this sandbox (relied on WebP

- **September 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh (this cycle):** Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarnyi, IFP News (Sept 7-13) — NPT-withdrawal process: 130-lawmaker statement, Parliament Presidium speech (Sept 13), Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News (Sept 17-18) — Trump's "big decision"/"annihilate" remark and the Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting (Sept 22, Iran-Oman Strait, Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) failing to renew the Iran-sanctions monitoring panel · IRNA (primary, via GlobalSecurity.org reprint), The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFC, Parapolitika, Rio Times (Sept 17-18) — IRGC's own statement (Sept 18, clean days vs. a "host state") and Times of Israel liveblog (Sept 19, Houthi-linked air-raid alert on Riyadh) — mixed proxy-front signal · TASS, Caspianpost, Mehr News, Samaa — FM Araghchi's Iran-Oman Strait "agreed a deal" (Sept 19)
- **September 18 light daily touch (prior cycle):** Axios — original interview, Trump's "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime (Sept 17, primary reporting of a direct quote) · Times of Israel, Politico Wire (Sept 18) — follow-up for corroboration of a claimed IRGC strike on a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz, Sept 18 — no named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC) source found that cycle; claim NOT corroborated
- **September 14 LIGHT DAILY touch: Oman News Agency (ONA) — state news agency statement, Sunday Sept 13, 2026: the Salalah regional meeting is "postponed to a later date ... in order to create conditions for a meeting"** (Sept 13) · The Washington Post, "Oman postpones regional talks on Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 13) · CNN, "Iran-Gulf talks without US participation on reopening the Strait of Hormuz postponed, Omani officials say" (Sept 13) · party-sourced, reported not scored — and for Brent \$107.54 / WTI \$102.34, market prices) · Malay Mail, "Oman postpones Iran-Gulf talks on Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 14) · Tehran Times / Mehr News, "FM Araghchi: Oman unwilling to participate in talks" (Sept 14) · corroborating the Araghchi statement · Checked and excluded as stale: Seatrade Maritime, Argus Media, Times of Israel and Gulf News reporting on drone strikes at Salalah and Duqm ports — those are dated March 1/3/18
- **September 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (prior cycle):** Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs — announcement (Friday Sept 11) that Iran will meet the GCC foreign ministers and Iraq in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss the Gulf states on Monday, Sept 11 · Dawn, "Tehran agrees to engage Gulf states over Hormuz future," Sept 12 · Arab News · Oman Observer, "Salalah to host Iran-GCC Hormuz talks on Monday" · The Business Standard · Bahrain's Sept 12 announcement that it will not participate — logged counterweight · Jerusalem Post, "No signed Hormuz deal expected yet from Oman, Gulf States meeting on Monday, Iranian official says" — logged counterweight · Mandeb fighting · TradingEconomics and Forbes — Brent's 4.24% Friday Sept 11 give-back to ~\$104.26, reported as a market price and explicitly not used to move P.
- **September 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (prior cycle):** Saudi Arabia's Ministry of Foreign Affairs — official statement confirming drone strikes on East-West Pipeline (Petroline) pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina, Sept 11 (no corroborating outlets) — probe of the Maysan operations command, commander dismissed, Shalamchek border crossing closed · President Trump's on-record Dublin remarks — Iran "probably" responsible (single, hedge, no UAE, urging "exercising maximum restraint" · Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge — re-verification that the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure still holds · TradingEconomics and
- **September 12 light daily catch-up (prior, this morning):** Al Jazeera ("Can the Houthis close the Red Sea after seizing the Yemen coast?," Sept 11) — Houthi capture of the entire Red Sea coastline · NBC News, CNBC, Newsweek, Reuters, UKMT0 Warning 133-26 (1910 UTC Sept 10, official) — four projectiles struck two vessels near Khasab, Oman, one afire · Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill — corroborating reporting on the Khasab incident · US confirmation found · local run.py quant refresh — BTC \$76,745.60 (Sept 13) vs. \$77,289.66 (Sept 12) vs. \$77,063.25 (Sept 11) vs. \$77,993.99 (Sept 10).
- **September 11 light daily catch-up:** Rigzone (Bloomberg wire, Sept 10) — Brent ended Thursday up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, highest in nearly four months; WTI closed above \$102, Brent above \$100, Vantage Markets, NAI500 (Sept 10) — corroborating Brent above \$100-102 on Hormuz strike risk · Reuters wire via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill (Sept 9) — Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 others) only as surfaced in search summaries (flagged as a degraded pull, not used alone to move P).
- **September 10 light daily catch-up:** Al Jazeera (Sept 9), MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org (Iran War 2026 Day 194) — corroborating reporting on Jordan's own military statement confirming the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at the Houthi seizure of the Yemeni port of Mocha, Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait · CNBC — Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9, first time since May · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$101.25 Tuesday Sept 9, data-fetch workflow — BTC \$77,993.99 (Sept 10) vs. \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8).
- **September 9 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship" (Sept 8, primary source): M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Housh, all warships, both evaded · CNBC — "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries" (Sept 9) · ABC News — corroborating Brent ~\$100.44 intraday, +2.57% · standing DoD casualty records (checked, not used)
- **September 8 light daily catch-up:** Press TV, Tehran Times (Iranian state media) — Mohsen Rezaei's (SNSC secretary) on-record statement, Sept 6-7, announcing intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's 12th Fleet boundaries not yet announced), The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency (aa.com.tr), Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same Rezaei statement · GlobalSecurity.org — Iran War 2026 Day 188 Brent ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 close · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7) vs. \$80,338.98 (Sept 6).
- **September 6 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships" (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, Jerusalem Post, Al Jazeera live blog ("Iran war live: IRGC claims attacks on 3 oil tankers and 3 US-linked ships," Sept 6) and Euronews (Sept 6, Iranian forces targeting a US naval drone) — Iran's own Sept 6 follow-on claims, not US-confirmed · Saturday Sept 6, no new print · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,929.30 (Sept 6) vs. \$79,646.11 (Sept 5).
- **September 3-5 re-check:** GlobalSecurity — Iran War 2026 Day 188-189 updates (Sept 3-4): Iran's second retaliatory wave hit Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE), both repeat targets; a US official confirmed analysis of images/video verified by Reuters, concluding the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding strike was likely a direct hit by a US munition (JSOW-type glide-bomb fragments); VP Vance's "extremely skeptical" comment, Sept 4, that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale attack" on Israel; IDF took the ridge Sept 3, no such attack confirmed as of this run.
- **September 2 light daily catch-up — CENTCOM-confirmed strikes plus multi-source reporting on the retaliation:** Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI — corroborating reporting on the CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes on the "tanker for tanker" policy · Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI — reporting on the Kuhestak, Hormozgan wedding-strike casualty claim (Hormozgan governor's office source; CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told Reuters Sept 2 coordinated strikes on Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait, interception rates, and the absence of a confirmed new US combat death · CNBC — Trump's "significantly larger response" threat and an unnamed senior I
- **September 1 light daily catch-up — UKMT0 log plus multi-source reporting:** UKMT0 — Senegal Prosperity incident log, Aug 31 (VLCC struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm NE of Khasab, Oman; port side, engine room hit) · the UAE Ministry of Defense's on-record denial of the target claim plus confirmation of an intercepted Iranian drone over UAE territorial waters · CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — Trump's on-record Aug 31 remarks that he

**August 31 light daily catch-up — on-record statement plus multi-source reporting:** CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawks (on the record, via Bloomberg/CNBC/Newsweek) — confirms the Aug 31 strike on oil tankers near Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 30) · NBC News — "U.S. forces strike Iranian rocket launchers... first military action in weeks" (Aug 30) · Newsweek — "US Forces Strike Iranian Military as Sea Mines Approach Strait of Hormuz, Jordan (Aug 31) · Jordan's military statement (via Fox News, HNGN) — 8 missiles intercepted · Al Jazeera — "Iran targets Jordan after first US attack in a month" (Aug 31) · Reuters/CNBC — renewed exchange w/ Iran" (Aug 31)

**August 29 full weekly refresh — direct primary-source adversarial fetches:** home.treasury.gov — press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic Day-Day") a digital-assets sectoral designation · law-firm trade-compliance client alerts (Aug 24-25) · fm.gov.om/en/53722 — Oman's own Foreign Ministry joint statement, Aug 25, confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor and mine-free zone

**August 29 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing update, +30%+ week-over-week (114 vs. 87 transits, week of Aug 17-23) · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz demining/zero-tolerance statement · UKMTO's Oman revenue-sharing claim, checked against and NOT confirmed by Oman's Foreign Ministry · TradingEconomics, various (Aug 25-28) — Brent ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), second source confirmed killed Jul 18-19, already in the standing total, not a new Aug 22-29 death · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,666.16 (Aug 29 close) vs. \$77,266.84 (Aug 22).

**August 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28 draft) — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; treated as abandoned/superseded, findings independently re-verified fresh above:** UKMTO-sourced Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz demining/zero-tolerance statement · Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal, Daily Sabah (all Aug 26) — IRCG spoils of war — Brent ~\$87.65-89/bbl (Aug 27), easing from the Aug 20-21 range.

**August 22 draft2 — second dedicated adversarial-verification pass (same-day full weekly refresh, independent of the morning fact-check below):** Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox — cumulative updates, the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly (may include the separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike, 6 killed per Al Jazeera) — NET FINDING: honest range 15-19 (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers), not a possible second incident, reconciled on cross-reference to the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera) · independent re-check for Aug 19-22 vessel strikes/seizures/incidents — none found

**August 22 morning draft — adversarial fact-check (dedicated, independent of the research pass below):** Riviera, UN News, and Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" tracker — REFUTES this report's own initial claim of a June 2026 Hormuz strike, cumulative toll 12-17 deaths across ~65 attacks per multiple outlets (see draft2 entry above for this cycle's further re-verification, which settles on a 15-19 range) · Al Jazeera, Bloomberg, Gulf News (all Aug 22) — "Iran's military operations in the Strait of Hormuz" (3 wounded, oil-loading disrupted), both predating and contradicting the "novel escalation vector" framing carried since Aug 20.

**August 20-22 verification (four parallel primary-source research passes):** UKMTO, Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247 (Aug 17-18) — bulkier Minoan Dignity struck, still detained Aug 19 · GlobalSecurity.org Day-175 tracker — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down · home.treasury.gov / Bessent public statements (Aug 20-22) — sanctions package for Iran (Aug 22) — Iran will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,266.84 (Aug 22 close, this cycle) vs. \$71,882.92 (Aug 20).

**August 18-20 verification:** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (all Aug 18) — UAE reports two Iranian ballistic missiles fired at its territory, one landing in territorial waters; Iran's foreign ministry denies involvement, calls it a possible escalation · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump threatens "the most crushing economic operation ever taken against any country" (new sanctions rhetoric); same-day, Trump softens "no time to negotiate" to "no time to negotiate" · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — "Iran threatens to bomb Oman with Iran war stuck in the Strait, engine damage, one crew injury · CBS and CNN (Aug 19) — Trump threatens "the most crushing economic operation ever taken against any country" (new sanctions rhetoric); same-day, Trump softens "no time to negotiate" to "no time to negotiate" · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — "Iran threatens to bomb Oman with Iran war stuck in the Strait, engine damage, one crew injury · CBS and CNN (Aug 19) — Trump threatens "the most crushing economic operation ever taken against any country" (new sanctions rhetoric); 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